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Virginia Board of Education, Lab Schools Standing Committee, Thursday, April 11, 2024

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- Official meeting video (VDOE, YouTube): https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=62BwxSP157w
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[00:00:33] May I begin, Claire? Yeah, we are good. Well, good afternoon, everyone. My name is Joan Wobiska.

[00:00:48] I'm the chair of the College Partnership Laboratory School Standing Committee, and welcome to the April meeting of the Standing Committee. It's my pleasure to call us to order. I'd like to note that the Standing Committee is holding an all-virtual public meeting in accordance with Section 2.2-3708.3 of the Code of Virginia and the all-virtual meeting policy adopted by the Virginia Board of Education on December 12, 2023.

[00:01:12] I would also like to welcome several distinguished guests who are joining us for the first time today. We have the Virginia President of the State Board of Education, Grace Creasy, with us, as well as I believe that later today we will be joined by the Virginia Department of Education Chief of Staff, Dr. Raley, and I've been told to also expect Dr. Lisa Coons, Superintendent of Public Instruction, who will be joining us.

[00:01:38] So let me first go to, oh, and I see Dr. Coons is on. That's fantastic. So let me go to President Creasy, and I'm sure that you'd like to greet the committee and the public and turn it over to you.

[00:01:50] Good afternoon, everyone. Thank you all for being here and being engaged in this really important and innovative work. I would like to thank Joan Wodiska, the chair of this committee, for the work that she has put in for the length of time here, about, I guess, 18 months now on this work, as well as the commitment of the other committee members here that you all have seen and worked with over your time through this process.

[00:02:20] And so this is critical work that we are so thankful you are all engaged in and just happy to be here with you all today and looking forward to hearing the committee's work. Thank you, President Creasy, and thank you for the opportunity to advise the board.

[00:02:41] Dr. Coons, as you have joined us as well, is there anything that you would like to say to the standing committee or yourself or Dr. Whaley? I'm just incredibly thankful for the work that is happening across the Commonwealth. We have visited several school divisions that are very excited and several lab school designers and had lots of conversations and so incredibly thankful of the guidance, support, and feedback that the Standing Committee provides.

[00:03:12] I also want to give a huge shout out to the DOE team and the support of others who have really helped us organize and shape a process that allows students to have this innovation. I want to say a particular thank you to you, Joan, who have really dedicated a great deal of time and effort to the Standing Committee and leading us in this work through the Standing Committee. So thanks so much. Thank you. At this time, Dr. Armstrong, would you call the role of the members of the Standing Committee, please? Yes, ma'am. Chair Wadisca. Present.

[00:03:51] vice chair moran president mr bailey president mr hansen president and mr rotherham i understand he'll be joining us later thank you at this time we would move to approval of the amended agenda i find myself in kind of an unusual position uh typically um we at the standing committee the well the agenda was transmitted to the public on monday as well as to the standing committee

[00:04:29] this mid-morning i received an amended version of the agenda and i see that that version of the agenda has not yet been publicly posted and so it is not quite as simple as would you like to approve the agenda as presented we could we should approve the agenda as presented to the committee on monday but i do recognize that a new version has been transmitted from video and this morning but i'm aware that that version is not publicly available um which you know i have some reservations

[00:05:07] about so at this time i will pause um take feedback from the committee members on how they would like to proceed and then we can devise how best to uh consider business before us adam chair would it be helpful if we had deb maybe map out the appropriate procedure for the committee certainly and madam chair one thing i apologize the i've just confirmed that the agenda

[00:05:42] is a global republic consumption on the website at this time right now at two o'clock and currently it is available could i could i ask madam chair that we have staff overview the changes in the amended agenda because i'm i have not received a copy of it and i'm not on the uh the website right now i can pull it up but it would be helpful if staff could just update all committee members on what changes are occurring in the amended agenda if that is okay i think that's a good

[00:06:19] suggestion as well thank you so why don't we go with um dr armstrong if you could provide an overview of the amended the proposed amended agenda and then uh miss love if you could please advise the committee as to an appropriate course of action at this time certainly our amended agenda includes

consideration by this committee of the same six applicants that have been presented originally to you all that includes emery and henry george mason roanoke paul decamp community

[00:06:56] college odu newport news and odu chesapeake in the amended agenda we did shift the presentation information items to the beginning of the agenda then we move the action items which include the application approvals after those information items we also added an item which is a consideration of a process change for the lab school standing committee and that is attached with a background document as well and that has been added in as item d so currently the the amended agenda is different from the original agenda provided to the Standing Committee both in the order in which

[00:07:35] we're receiving reports with our presentations and written reports still being the pipeline update and innovation network but those are coming first followed by consideration of applications and then we have added an item in the action items that's item d to consider the college partnership laboratory school process revisions thank you dr armstrong um miss love as the representative here from the office of the attorney general um what is the public notice requirement

[00:08:11] for so has this information now just been made available for the public so um just for those members of the committee who i haven't had the opportunity yet my name is dev love and i'm the chief of the education section in the attorney general's office you're more accustomed to seeing susan williams or abby gump uh here um but um i guess i drew the i guess the long straw today to be able to be here with you all um so the requirement in foia there's no requirement in foia that the agenda be posted or made available at any particular time well be posted

[00:08:50] online at any particular time it needs to be available to the public at the same time it is available to the board of education or to members of this committee um now if it's posted online it's obviously available to anybody who has online access but i think it's it's um fair to say that the agenda was available at the time it was created it was available to the public so had there been a request from a citizen of the commonwealth for a copy of the revised agenda um it would be a public record that would be made available you know upon request um obviously it's

[00:09:27] helpful to have it posted online um so um you know that's a good thing that that has been addressed but there's been no no violation of foia in not having it posted at the moment the meeting started is that clear enough thank you um i will entertain a motion from a member of the committee as to how they would like to see us proceed with our business today and we'll just see how those

[00:09:58] motions go and that will determine the course of our discussion i will move the agenda as we currently have it for approval for our meeting today is there a second a second although it was in favor of the amended agenda as presented please signify by saying aye aye no all those in

[00:10:34] opposition they signify by saying no no as well as no okay so let's try this again um is there a motion to approve the agenda as presented to the committee on monday and distributed to the public on monday dr moran since you voted no on the last night i'm just concerned that i literally

[00:11:08] just received a copy of the amended agenda that came in with a batch of documents from um claire at about one o'clock a little before one o'clock i was not in my house at the time so i wasn't able to look at it so what i would really like to know is um a little bit more about what those changes in that amended agenda um entail um because i've not had a chance to really review the the changes

[00:11:40] to the amended agenda um i think the only change that andy uh mentioned was item d so maybe if we just hear a little bit more about that um and i know it's we're going to go into detail but item b is to change um what mr armstrong i was working on i'm going to share my screen if that's okay

[00:12:20] madam chair can i put the agenda on the screen for everybody as i talk through that i think that would be very helpful thank you bear with me one moment please thank you mr armstrong for putting that up sure thank you i just want to make sure you can see it managing seems a little bit different Madam Chair, committee members, I'll walk through this briefly with you.

[00:12:58] So you can see here we have our typical opening items here with the approval of this agenda, approval of minutes, public comment. We then move into presentations and written reports, which include the pipeline update presentation, which I will lead.

[00:13:14] It'll be similar to what we saw in March. And then we have a update on our standing item, which is the lab schools and innovation network that we have also discussed in the past few meetings. Moving from that, we have our Memorandum on Eligibility of Private Schools, which I believe was included in the original agenda that was distributed to the Standing Committee.

[00:13:37] Following that, we have the new item, which is item D, and that is consideration of first and final review of college partnership laboratory school process revisions, which I will discuss. And then we move into our application reviews, and that goes from Emory & Henry to Roanoke, DECAMP, ODUs, and then we will finish out with the typical agenda items, which are the discussion of issues, public comment, and adjournment. Okay, thank you, Mr. Armstrong. I just want to make the point for the record that it is really difficult to receive items that have been added to the agenda

[00:14:15] at the last minute in an amended way and be able to actually review those for the purposes of being able to have a cogent discussion at the committee level. So just in the future, it's always helpful to get the complete and full agenda on the timeline that we typically operate on in advance, so I appreciate you giving that update. Thank you. Yes, ma'am. Thank you. At this time, why don't I offer a motion to, as someone who voted in the negative, I will offer a motion to approve the

[00:14:51] amended agenda as presented. I second. Thank you, Dr. Moran. All those in favor of approving the amended agenda that was transmitted to the public at two o'clock today please signify by saying aye aye aye chair votes aye as well and the agenda is now adopted dr armstrong i believe you'll proceed with item a which is the pipeline update yes ma'am thank you and again bear with me as i

[00:15:24] share my screen madam chair uh is this do i need to make that shift we made earlier when we were practicing yeah that would be helpful trust the display that means button i believe yes apologies

[00:15:57] is kevin online i'm sorry i'll do this once don't have it good for the rest of this presentation here you're okay dr i'm sorry can you click through otherwise show me the way kevin

[00:16:32] yep it's at the top of the screen right there like towards the left side uh you have a display settings if you go up towards the top yeah i'm not seeing that for some reason uh it's just a right up right above lab schools it's at the very top of the screen uh hang tight for me okay thank

[00:17:07] you all for your patience no while we're waiting um actually i'm going to take a we'll handle two

[00:17:59] other quick items on the agenda the first is the approval of the minutes is there a motion to approve the minutes as presented to the standing committee second thank you mr hansen and doc and dr

moran is there um with that motion on the table is there all those in favor please signify by saying aye aye aye aye aye aye aye the chair votes aye as well any opposed all right the motion unanimously passes and then some minutes are approved i believe we have no public comment on agenda items but i

[00:18:36] will just double check with claire claire is there any public comment on agenda items before the standing committee today no ma'am i can confirm there are no public comments okay the standing committee accepts public comment on all matters related to the college partnership laboratory schools in Virginia public comment is an important part of our deliberation and valued by the committee members the committee members will accept public comment on any agenda items and we really do value that impact as I noted and for the benefit of the committee as well as for the public record we do ask that if when we have public commenters to please state their

[00:19:11] name their organization and to limit their remarks to three minutes if possible given the time and across to travel around the commonwealth which is rather vast we really do want to encourage the public to utilize anytime they so chose the ability to provide virtual public comments because we really do want to hear from you so at this time as claire has indicated we don't have any public comment on our agenda items and at the end of our meeting today if there is any public comment on non-agenda items or any additional public comments that members who are listening would like us to take we'll be happy to do so at that time so i just want to let you know that you'll

[00:19:47] have two bites at that apple so with that i'm going to check in and see how we're doing on item a we're getting there all right i love it uh the pipeline update is a wonderful update that dr armstrong has been providing to the committee um i think almost since uh his arrival at the vdoe and we look forward to receiving this information every month it gives us a good forecast it was a great suggestion from Mr. Hansen. I think at our very first committee meeting Mr. Hansen suggested wouldn't it be nice if we had a forecast of what work is coming and what is the status of different

[00:20:24] applications and the intention of the report that Dr. Armstrong is about to present gives us that crystal ball of what might be coming and what we need to do in trouble. And so hopefully Dr. Armstrong has utilized our time well and I'm now passing it back to you.

[00:20:41] I believe so and Kevin's going back to look so thank you all for your patience. are we good to go correct it looks good thank you uh madam chair thank you members of committee and for the public joining us today for your understanding i would like to briefly provide an update on the progress and pipeline of our lab schools both those that have now been approved and those that are currently under review by the video as the chair presented to the standing committee in march our lab school applications can be considered either under review complete and compliant in preparation for standing committee review pending before the standing

[00:21:20] committee or approved ultimately by the way of the Virginia Board of Education's affirmative vote and this activates the preparation of contracts between the Institute of Higher Education or the IHE and the Board of Education for execution and distribution of funding. This overview includes the details of the lab school application review process. Since our last meeting of the standing committee this process has incorporated significant additional supports to ensure that the standing committee is in receipt of complete and compliant applications including dedicated budget and sustainability support to applicants and approved lab schools by the governor's transformation

[00:21:57] office and secretary of education and a multi-step review by the office of the attorney general to ensure statutory compliance furthermore the video completes its subject matter expert review and is in the process of hiring an additional staff member to support the work of implementation videoe policy staff have also been given dedicated responsibility in the office of innovation toward lab school application review and contract work i want to take this moment to give my deepest thanks to everyone who i just mentioned who has supported our work and continues to do so our subject matter expert team represents expertise from the videoe in all critical areas to ensure quality and

[00:22:37] completeness of lab school applications i look forward to working with the chair to recognize these individuals at our next meeting. The VDOE has received 21 lab school applications, most of which have been submitted since July 1st, 2023. In less than nine months, we have worked with applicants, the Standing Committee, the Board of Education, and our partners in support to move six applications to full Board of Education approval with six additional pending applications, and they're going to be before the Standing Committee today.

[00:23:09] and we also have a number of other applications under review and i believe the exact number that we have under review right now is six but we do have a few planning grants that are still being worked on by applicants as well we heard about our approved lab schools at the march standing committee meeting and those included vcu code rva germanus future educators academy the university of mayor and washington academy of technology and innovation and the jmu lab school for innovation and career exploration and since then excuse me the boe has approved an additional

[00:23:44] two lab schools the uva innovation hub at charlesville middle school as well as the mountain gateway technology education center known as mg tech these newly approved lab schools now have our initiative serving nearly 1 000 students beginning in 2024 with over 2 500 just from these approved applicants alone by the year 2029. This map highlights our approved and under review lab schools as well as those two existing planning grant applications still in progress. I do want to note the regional diversity across the commonwealth with our lab schools. And finally,

[00:24:24] everybody's favorite slide is our pipeline update which lists all of our applicant higher education institutions for either planning grants or lab schools along with their estimated funding request and we are excited to realize what will certainly be full spend down of this 100 million dollars provided by the governor to make these last schools a reality so i'm going to see if i can do a better job of stopping my share than i did with making the share and take any questions of the committee thank you dr armstrong let's go to questions from committee members first

[00:24:56] dr armstrong not necessarily a question but just a continued thank you to you and the staff and the whole team at the department that uh you know just since joining the state board almost two years ago i uh really deeply uh respect the work and the discipline and the thought and the evaluation that as well as helping work with our partners uh um of you know the who are submitting the applications

[00:25:29] and i just think the team has done a terrific job in helping uh navigate and coach and uh nurture uh these uh this critical local relationships around the state and just uh really i know it's also just been a great magnitude of work as well and so i just really want to repeat what i said previously but really just with the especially the amount of work that you know we have before us with the six applications today and the other six or seven that are

[00:26:03] in the pipeline just uh really thank you for the again your diligence and uh you know the timeliness and you know the work that you guys have been about thank you any other questions from members of the committee dr armstrong one question that that i wanted to ask about is that um in looking

[00:26:35] over the pipeline document it appears that jmu is asking for less money than they were originally which is always great when people can find efficiencies. And so my question is, are there some things that either they're not going to do or are there things that they just have found some efficiencies that are representing that lower request number?

[00:27:00] Yeah, it's not. That's a great question, Dr. Moran. And we have worked with JMU to refine that budget ask as we've negotiated that contract with the help of the superintendent. and it is not going to adversely impact the programming i think they were able to really push on some enrollment levers that would significantly impact some of that per pupil funding and it but it will still ensure a quality experience for those students and the one that was outlined in the approved application okay thank you thank you dr moran any other

[00:27:37] questions for members of the committee okay all right i have two notations um if you can pull your slides back up i think there might be two inadvertent errors in the document yes ma'am give me one second all right at this slide dr armstrong i see that it indicates that there are four lab

[00:28:11] applicants that have withdrawn um i am aware of five lab applicants that have withdrawn one of them had been eastern shore but on one of the other slides it indicates that three have withdrawn what what is the accurate what is just double checking what is your number right now and which are the ones that are withdrawn that's a great question um the the answer to the second

[00:28:45] part of your question madam chair the the verbiage in that slide was withdrawn applications since lynchburg had never submitted their application they had submitted a planning grant but had never formally submitted a video application then they are among the they they withdrew from the process but i don't consider them among those who withdrawn applications and then eastern shore has re-engaged and we are meeting with some potential partners to revive that so i did change that from withdrawal

[00:29:23] to a tbd for the time being thank you for the clarification and then could you scroll back a couple slides will be the process slide one more um on this slide go one back um on step five six and seven for pending i this slide is different than would you please explain on this

[00:29:59] side um step five six and seven since that appears to be different than what was on the slide at the last committee meeting yes ma'am and um and i will make a slight correction here as this was originally intended to be further down the agenda for your consideration today i'll be discussing the proposed revision to the lab school process document and while this was and has been i think the wording you would have seen for steps five six and seven would have been more than one standing

[00:30:35] committee public review including opportunity public comment and 10-day public comment period i did amend that to holding one public review so again putting that a bit before the horses we still need to consider that action but that would have been i assume the change that you would have seen so what is the current process of the standing committee if it was to have been accurately reflected in this slide the most the standing committee process and i'll get into this more when we consider uh the item i believe it's item d coming up the standing committee process which

[00:31:12] is representing a flow chart that was approved by the standing committee in i believe march of 2023 i have those details coming up did indicate that the applicant would submit their application for doe review when it was complete and compliant it would be before the standing committee and then the standing committee would conduct review and then send it for any further edits and then return after public comment for another standing committee review before going to the Board of Education. And then again, I'm speaking just off of memory of what I saw on the flowchart.

[00:31:49] I have that accessible and that item that's coming up. That's sufficient, Dr. Armstrong. Thanks very much. Hearing no further questions, I believe at this time we can proceed with item B, which is Virginia Lab Schools and the Innovation Network. Dr. Armstrong, you have the floor, so keep going doing a great job all right thank you i'm gonna i can just keep this sharing uh going in one moment please so i'll do a little setup on this one while we're would you like that yes please that'd be great all right um since the again since the beginning of the discussions of the standing

[00:32:29] committee it has been very important to stand committee members as well as we have heard that it's very important to the lab school applicants themselves that we really help create an ecosystem and a support network so that they can be the most successful in the endeavor that they're taking on and one of the things that we've discussed at every committee meeting is the creation of a innovation network to not only capture the innovation that is being cultivated from approved lab schools but the innovation that we know that exists in the commonwealth through other public

[00:33:08] schools such as governor schools uh cte schools there's a lot of different types of innovative models that are being used across the commonwealth and so this has been a perennial item on the agenda that we ask for hey what is going how will we as a commonwealth support not only approved lab schools which i'm hoping that the number of the applicants on the phone today are hearing you're not going to go it alone we're talking about what kind of support you're going to have how we're going to create a professional learning community for you to collaborate with one another to learn from one another and so this agenda item is a standing item for us it's important to understand

[00:33:45] how do we actually take those good intentions and actualize them into deliverables and concrete support to both applicants as well as to catalog the innovative models we have dr armstrong back to you thank you and it is the visual working for you madam chair it is on the screen okay i'll take it. Let's go. Thank you, Madam Chair and committee members. Our work continues to shift from review and approval of lab school applications to the, as you mentioned, critical work of

[00:34:23] providing a network and dedicated supports to newly established lab schools that are preparing for operations. And in this spirit, I do want to provide a brief update on the work of the BDOE in collaboration with the Secretary of Education to make our lab schools, whether currently operational beginning operations in 2024 those beginning in 2025 the resources they need to be day one ready and beyond and to do this as you can see here the the agency is currently developing lab school opening action kits for all of our fall 2024 operational lab schools

[00:34:58] we are going to be creating thematic sub networks for lab schools that share common workforce and content focus areas and we look forward to establishing a regular cadence of monthly and on-demand calls, site visits, and convenings to problem-solving, network, and anticipation of opening. This is not radically different than what we've done with our applicants already, but again, we're going to put the same efforts into really supporting our applicants as they become operational and keeping that

cadence of regular contact, site visits, and really formalized and well-developed supports for them moving forward. Our current 2024 lab schools, meaning

[00:35:38] those that will that are slated to begin operations here in in the fall ahead and these are approved and pending lab schools including some that are before you all today for consideration is included here in this list and these are we know those lab schools that are going to need the most significant and immediate support as they are looking to open their doors to students if they haven't already like vcu code rba likely this august or september in the meantime we anticipate convening a summit of those 2024 lab schools followed by individual consults and

[00:36:15] progress check-ins throughout may in the summer and also dedicated work to prepare for that just as we know in k-12 it's complex work of k-12 compliance and making sure that all of our lab schools are are well up to date and and have the resources they need to be compliant in the areas of HR, FERPA, reporting, and finance. And then we look forward to being there side by side with our lab schools as they kick off this fall for kickoff events and giving them support into the fall as

[00:36:45] well. To dig deeper, we have really segmented this work into three phases in the chronological order, so to speak, of the supports we're going to provide to our lab schools, April to June, June to August, and August to October. And we have assigned actions and focus areas that are really based on the the needed rhythm and timelines that that are in deadlines that we know are associated with a typical k-12 school year now mind you all this is being compressed into a tighter window of time than any currently operational public school would be experiencing and we're

[00:37:23] aware of that we're going to make sure we mobilize the resources these lab schools need to be successful these are our next steps as we implement and really finalize that that day one kit establish regular contact with these 2024 lab schools and especially continue to support the activation of business industry k-12 partners higher ed philanthropic partners for long-term sustainability we are planning for program evaluation and just again getting very solid plans for how we're going to support our 2024 lab schools moving forward very brief overview but

[00:38:01] i have a a window outside my office where i've been kind of whiteboarding a lot of this uh with the support of other staff members here in the hc and the secretary's office as well and we're excited to to really be shoulder to shoulder with our lab schools as they kick off their operations thank you dr armstrong you've done a tremendous job of providing i feel the need to say and i know that i can do this safely on behalf of all committee members you've done an amazing job providing technical support and coaching to lab school applicants and who have really done we would not have been able to do this work without you so i want to say thank you thank you our

[00:38:40] applicants have been have been wonderful too they've been responsive and patient and i appreciate their their willingness to take a risk and do this i know it's going to pay off any questions on this item from members of the committee hearing none other than our gratitude i think we're going to be ready to move on to action and discussion items but i don't want to it's a little easier sometimes when we're in person i can get the non-verbal if you want to talk so i'm looking at the screen quickly if i miss anyone ever just chime in but i think we're good to go than otherwise

[00:39:14] to action and discussion items um typically before we go into action and discussion items i always give a quick overview of a status of where things are at some of that has already been touched upon by dr armstrong but i'm just going to do a quick overview just for the purposes of we have some new folks

on the call some of our lab applicants that may have not heard this before so let me just do a quick run through it's almost the same thing i said back in march but here we go as members of the standing committee our responsibility as charged by the state board of education has been to develop procedures for reviewing receiving and ruling on applications from virginia's public

[00:39:52] colleges and universities to establish public lab schools and since day one the committee members have dispatched this here with great care, creating a rigorous and high quality, as you've heard, deliberative process to review applications. And the Standings Committee's focus has been on durable, financially sustainable, locally supported public lab schools that are open to all children and that adhere to applicable state and federal laws. The approved Standing Committee's process, as was already discussed by Dr. Armstrong, was first considered by the committee in March of 2023, was unanimously approved by the Standing Committee in April

[00:40:28] of 2023 and includes two public periods and attended public comment period affording the committee opportunity to carefully review applications to support applicants and to ensure that a quality application is referred to the state board of education for their deliberation and as part of this process recognizing the complexity to open a public school in virginia the committee has relied heavily upon subject matter experts such as dr armstrong and other members of the team at the virginia department of education to review applications and to determine if an application is complete and compliant um here's uh dr armstrong has reviewed kind of the

[00:41:05] status of where we are i would like to highlight that of the site visits that the video team and the standing committee have done five of the seven site visits that we personally did for customized technical support five of those visits resulted in a few public lab schools and as i've said our process is intentionally deliberate according parties including the applicant time to improve and refine and reflect on the work to ensure a quality outcome for children and part of the preparation of this work the standing committee considered best practices we looked at research and we received expert testimony including expert testimony from the international association of

[00:41:44] lab schools i als provided testimony to the committee that helped us refine our lab school applications and to emphasize the importance of what composes the core components that uniquely define and differentiate a lab school from other models of schools. Those include the three things that are kind of really particularly unique to lab schools. The first is around teaching, that there is support within a lab school that helps refine and enhance the preparation and the pipeline to prepare teachers. The second is what goes on with learning, that there really are

[00:42:20] innovative learning and curricular developments and supports for students that are deeper and innovative and substantive and number three that there's a component of research that a lab school is this very nature as a laboratory affords us all research that can help not only enhance but inform the broader education community and its practice we want to again congratulate all the applicants that have made it through this regular process we're excited about the work that you are engaging in and very appreciative for your collaboration with the standing committee and for your work with our staff so with that we are going

[00:42:59] to dive into item c which is a memorandum of eligibility on private schools this item will be presented by mcdeb love from the office of attorney general i'm sure will be providing information on the eligibility of private universities in the lab school process for the benefit of the committee members i do

want to just remind you um we can receive information from miss love in open session should you have questions or need to deliberate the standing committee members as this is a legal counsel would have to go into closed session so happy to have questions from the

[00:43:36] standing committee members should you like to do so please signal that to myself we will work with our staff when we move into closed session so that you can ask that question and we can deliberate in then we would come back and join everyone in session so i just want to give everybody the benefit of knowing how we procedurally proceed in this virtual environment so with that um miss love if you would please uh present item c did she i know she sent a note that said she was

[00:44:12] going away stepping away for a moment is she back and i do say mr rotherham let me know for the record that mr rotherham has joined us for the meeting hello andy hi thanks for substitute for Deb Love though I'm sorry. I don't see Deb Love we're just having a bang of time with this virtual meeting today so maybe we should go to item D let's I'm gonna roll the dice and I'm gonna say we're gonna just come back to item C because we can't do it without her let's go to item D which

[00:44:48] is first and final review of the college partnership laboratory school process revision this is the item that was added today and with that is Dr. Armstrong are you presenting this item? yes ma'am madam chair and i'll i'll talk through it first and then i'll go through the the sharing process again um in your agenda you you have attached a a background overview document as well as a proposed revision of the lab school process document and i did want to provide just

[00:45:24] some highlights of that background as you'll note in the executive summary within the attached document this change in process is being recommended for several reasons importantly as i mentioned in our pipeline update the internal processes that have iterated during the past eight months in our review and processing of lab school applications has engaged various resources to support the work of the agency in order to provide this committee with complete and compliant applications while past applications did require multiple stages standing committee and boe review the applications you have before you today and you will have in the future have been through

[00:46:02] multiple stages of subject matter expert review at least two stages of oag review and have had significant budget and sustainability feedback and revisions in response to the work of the videoe in partnership with the governor's transformation team this enhanced effort should assure the committee that any edits or changes required of an applicant subsequent to standing committee review can be resolved prior to consideration by the Board of Education, who, according to the Board of Education-approved guidelines for laboratory school applications, have opportunity to conduct multiple reviews of the lab school application. In the standing committee process

[00:46:39] graphic that the revision is included, the revision deletes the second standing committee review, and this aligns our standing committee process and practice to the Board of Education-approved guidelines which require a meeting with the standing committee uh with opportunity for public comment followed by a report and recommendation to the board of education so i am recommending to the committee approval of this process revision first and final review and i will share that for the for the committee and for the meeting as well at this time for discussion dr armstrong are you able to get the visual of that for the benefit of the committee members of

[00:47:19] the public to see yes yes I'm just gonna leave it there if that works yeah you can see um questions let's go to questions from committee members first Bill do you have a question are you adjusting

your camera just adjusting making this bigger for my old eyes okay questions from committee members

[00:47:51] comments or dr moran go ahead just seeing this right now and and getting the amended agenda with this item um one of the the questions that i just have um mr armstrong andy is is there a compelling reason and is it time related to get through um review of all these applications and get the ones that we've approved to move on moving as quickly as possible or is there some other rationale for

[00:48:27] why we would change the process right now just for my benefit and the benefit of the public and dr moran i would i would state that even if we had you know five years to obligate our funds that the work we're putting into review now ahead of standing committee review i feel does not necessitate the second review that's one dimension of the rationale the other is that the the state board of education approved guidelines i've got them beside me right now actually for the submission

[00:49:01] or approval of laboratory school applications that was approved in february of 2023 and to my knowledge this process and this was before i came on board i'm sure some of you would recall this the process we had before us today was never approved by the state board though it was approved by the standing committee another again dimension of my rationale here is to ensure that that the process that the standing committee is operating under also aligns with the board of education

[00:49:31] approved guidelines thank you dr armstrong any other let's go to mr hansen and mr rofferham dr thank you again for this and i um just again i'm just uh you know the number of opportunities that you know we have to um uh effectively you know move quality applications along the process

[00:50:03] i just think again commend the staff for your work commend you know the applicants as well and i just think this is very much in alignment with you know our progression over the last year plus both in the evolution of the application pool and just the nature of work and where we are and where we're going. So I think this is a very logical transition step for us to be undertaking.

[00:50:43] Yeah, I want to basically echo the same thing. Mr. Armstrong, thank you so much. I think as we've gone through this, we've learned some lessons about process and I appreciate you applying them it's it's we've got we need to remember we've got folks who've you know in some cases you know come a long way to be with us when we have live meetings and uh you know or come to richmond in the process yeah i think we just need to continue to try to refine it to maintain the highest bar on quality but also think about how can we do it as efficiently as possible you know everybody involved in the process uh you know these are educators who have full-time uh jobs

[00:51:22] or doing other things and to try to accommodate that. I think like the learning we have right now, you've done a very thoughtful job applying it and we're going to continue to learn lessons on this. Any other comments?

[00:51:40] I have a few of my own, but I always speak last. So I want to make sure I go to everyone first. Okay. Respectfully, this is an item that I will indicate that I will be voting now on.

[00:51:57] And I will do so on a principle for the following reason. as a local school board member and a prior member of the state board of education it was ingrained in me that a quality process equals a quality outcome and paramount in that is the public's engagement public's opportunity to review materials to have opportunity to deliberate and as evidenced even by the agenda today i think that we have work to be done to ensure that we are truly having the deliberative process i personally believe that it is important

[00:52:36] to have a first and a second review i know that that's not always done in today's environment but it is something historically that the state board has done and as a former member of the state board and as a member of a standing committee i know that first and second review was part of the work i believe that that work worked well and up until this month um the state board of education and has received we've received a tremendous amount of positive feedback from the state board of education on our review process and i think it's been working and so i see no reason

[00:53:15] to change course the second reason that i'll be voting no is that this item was sent to the committee members digitally today at 10 37. it was not loaded for the public's consideration until after our meeting began at two o'clock and again as a matter of principle i don't believe that i believe that we have a responsibility to run a quality process and not providing information in a timely manner to the committee members as well as to the public jeopardizes the ability to

[00:53:55] have that deliberative review process the last thing this is an important note for me as well the role of the standing committee the very role of a standing committee as charged under law is to set a process to review applications that is our role that is our charge there are millions of taxpayer dollars at stake in these conversations but most importantly is the welfare of the students and the educational professionals that will be at the lab school while there have been process

[00:54:29] improvements two of which i can speak to very directly the first is the office of the attorney general will be assisting in the review of application as you will hear from deb love when she's available the office of the attorney general's review and i quote does not look at curricular considerations financial plans or budget aspects of any lab school proposal and she the office of attorney general is unable to offer their opinion on the merits of an application. Those responsibilities lie within the standing committee. The second is the, since March,

[00:55:09] the Governor's Transformation Office has provided additional support to applicants to provide budget information and to procure spreadsheets as we will see in the other applicants on our agenda today. The Governor's Office, while I very much appreciate the spreadsheets that have been provided by the governor's office, identifying a number is not having a sustainable funding plan, and the role of determining whether or not an applicant is sustainable is a duty that has been

[00:55:46] charged to the standing committee. As a local school board member, I built a budget based on revenues and expenses, and we have been charged to ensure that the lab schools must have a plan that is financially sustainable this has been underscored to me that it is absolutely and so i am uncomfortable that at this juncture in our process that this change is being made and i am uncomfortable that this proposal has been provided at the last minute to not only the

[00:56:25] standing committees for their consideration but to the public writ large so i need no respect to disrespect in the process to anyone those comments are not directed at any one particular person but it is something as a principle of how i've led my 20 years of public service in the commonwealth that i feel strongly on that if you have a process that's working there's a quality process you should stick with that quality process so that has been said um is there a motion to approve

[00:56:59] for first and final the proposed revisions to the lab school review process as proposed by the urgency second and can we speak to the amendment once it's absolutely so there's first and there's a second and at this time then i'll further dr robert or mr watherham i promoted you mr rotherham um additional comments on this item yeah sorry i said amendment i spent i meant the motion

[00:57:30] um uh yeah look i i hear uh uh mr disc i i hear i hear your concern and i know it comes to a place as a principal. I feel like what we're doing here is simply streamlining the process based on what we've learned. We can take, if we see deficiencies in applications, it leaves us a couple of options. As I understand, it does not preclude us from taking something on first review, but we can take it. We can also send it through to the board with conditions.

[00:57:59] And fundamentally, what we're doing here is incredibly important, and you've done really important work helping establish a process, but fundamentally, the accountability for actually authorizing these schools lies with the the state board and the nine members of the state board who it's incumbent on them to look at everything including the public comment which is still provided for um uh in this process we still have a normal you know 10-day opportunity for the public uh to weigh in so i i hear your concerns certainly but i think this is this is mostly about how do we just streamline this process a little bit based on what we've we've

[00:58:35] learned not in a way that compromises quality but in a way that just maximizes uh efficiency while maintaining while maintaining quality so i appreciate your comments uh obviously because i seconded uh mr hansen's motion i'm going to support the change dr marianne i'd like to speak to this as well and i'm just hearing seeing this um in front of me today and i will tell you there's nothing more important to me than getting to yes on innovative practices and getting those into place and feel like I had a great track record of doing that at the district level, the division

[00:59:13] level. I also believe that getting to yes means that you have to have all of the pieces of the puzzle in place in order to be able to move an innovation project forward, whether it's a lab school or charter school, and I had two in Albemarle while I was a superintendent there, or any other pathway that's going to provide kids with different ways of getting to graduation in successful ways. One of the things that I would like to see is rather than seeing the second review struck is that I could see a compromise in this, Mr. Rotherham, with saying if we believe

[00:59:53] that an application is in good standing, it's hit all of the right buttons with the standing committee, that that first review could be the place where it then goes forward to the state board. And if there are some what you might call low-level conditions that we want to attach to that by saying, you know, before it goes to the state board, we'd like for you to work back with staff on X, Y, or Z, that we could say with these conditions, we see this as ready to go to the state board. I don't want to see the second review completely removed from the process, because I

[01:00:28] think it can be confusing. So if there is a way to put the second review in as a contingency, So that if we get to that first review and we feel like that that group has not really crossed all their T's and dotted all their I's, that we're able to send it back for a second review in order to get what we feel in place in terms of quality.

[01:00:54] And for me, it is about compliance. It is about meeting all of the standards that we have, but it's also about sustainability. It's about the strength of the program. And there's some other criteria that people have been using at the committee level to say, have you really thought through this? Have you thought through that?

[01:01:12] So I don't know if it's possible to look for a genius of the and in here and say, we absolutely would love to be able to move people on from first review if they've hit all of the right marks that we've set for these projects.

[01:01:27] But if we feel like we need a second review, that it is in the process that we can go there. So I would offer that up and would appreciate if there's any comment on that from fellow committee members. Dr. Armstrong, do you want to speak to that for a moment? It's my understanding from other conversations. Would you please speak to that and what you believe the intention of this would be?

[01:01:54] And Madam Chair, as I mentioned, Dr. Moran, the rationale for this, of course, is both in a nod to the work that we're doing ahead of standing committee review, but also the alignment with the Board of Education guidelines that were approved. But other than that, this is, of course, up to the the committee and their ultimate action on this item madam chair please proceed mr hanson um

[01:02:25] just thank you all i appreciated the comments from pam and andy and andy um you know and also just you know with respect manager too i really do believe that you know this committee has just done yeoman's work the staff attend terrific work as a current member of the state board of education i also believe that there is a lot of dedication and attention that's you know paid to this by the state board as well and so i you know as we launched up on this effort a while back and having

[01:03:00] the process in place to ensure quality outcomes i don't think anything has changed i think it's the evolution of where we are where the department of education is where we are in the process and i just don't really have any concerns whatsoever that we're going to be stepping away from quality outcomes of what we're all seeking to achieve here. And I think, as Andy said,

[01:03:34] the accountability is at the state board level and to really dig into the good work of this committee and the staff as we always do and so i um and also pam i in some respects didn't see that much um difference between what you were suggesting and kind of where we are and uh just uh appreciated

[01:04:04] your uh comments of you know maybe having the second review be um you know an option or something if you know need be on a case-by-case basis but just maybe if there's anything more that you'd like to elaborate on that but I appreciated the thoughtful suggestion there Dr. Moran would you like to say more about what you're thinking well I just I noted and I think you know we're

[01:04:40] dealing all with screens here but I did note that the second review had been redlined out on the the process and so i would not want anyone that's going through this process to say wait a second you're going to send us back for a second review it's not in the process that that can happen so i just wanted to make sure that um one of the words i learned in the work that i've done over the years is clarity is really key so i want to be sure that we have clarity with any of our folks now or perhaps in the future who come forward and are going through process that they

[01:05:15] clearly understand that if our goal is that we really are trying to get people out of the gate and that they've met all of our conditions and requirements, let's move them on. But if we have conditions and send them back, that they will not be surprised that that could happen, if that makes sense. I have one additional perspective I would like to share. The standing committee could

[01:05:48] certainly retain the discretion to do first and final on an application if we deemed that it was a quality application and ready to go but by changing the process it does change the review and it changes the ability to also provide support to applicants and i see emory and henry on my screen so my apologies dear applicant it is not my intention to pick on you but i'm going to use you as an exemplar to help tell the story for the moment when we first began this work something that

[01:06:27] i had learned from being on the state board was that success and education is built around partnerships the state supporting the local school division or higher ed institution and not merely just wagging a finger and saying hey you didn't get it right and you need to do something differently and that really impressed upon me that it had that the role when you have applicants go through a process like this is that they need sometimes coaching and support as i indicated in my opening

[01:07:00] remarks seven of five of our seven technical site visits which is another way of saying five of our seven coaching sessions resulted in high quality lab school applications at this juncture in the process given the expedited timeline it has been harder for our applicants to get that type of support at our last committee meeting emory and henry have some hiccups in their application they have been able to get additional technical support from voe as well as legal i know that they've made additional changes and we're looking forward to considering their application my

[01:07:39] additional concern with having only one review of an application is it could inadvertently press this committee to go up and down both on lab school applications versus being a partner in the work so i think it's i i agree with dr moran i would very much like to have a an expectation setting conversation about if we make this change what would it mean for the applicant as well if they get a no vote or if they don't get approved for first review do they as dr moran

[01:08:17] indicated do they get to go and have technical assistance and support or is it now just a no and i think uh you know to mr hansen and mr rotherham i'd love to hear your views on this as the members of the state board um if you know dr moran mr bailey i or yourself have any reservations about an application what is now the appropriate vehicle to and help help our applicants ensure that those reservations are addressed or corrected and emory henry was a great example where they had a language that would have been out of compliance with the state law

[01:08:55] around dual enrollment that language was through a technical support was changed they now will have open enrollment for all students and we're looking forward to considering their application so there's two sides of this coin when you close down the process to deliberation and reviewing and how would you see at this juncture what type of support can be provided to an applicant and

[01:09:24] what would be the timeline therein i'm happy to speak to that but mr bailey you haven't spoken yet so i want to make sure and mr hansen may have thoughts as well miss morand i think this last question is a good one to explore i guess i part of the way i was thinking about this i think really important points that were raised um by everyone but also it felt to me especially with one of the things i've noticed is that with the department doing more intensive um reviews up front

[01:10:02] and some assistance there we were just getting better quality um applications for first review didn't take care of all situations but it feels like like this revised process just puts more onus on uh the department of ed to some degree um and then also i shared i think you know andy's you know perspective too that at the end of the day we're recommending to the state board state board is sort of evaluating the risks and trade-offs with uh with the recommendations and so i i'd always just assumed a little bit that if there but this last point the jones raising i think is a good one that i thought if this wasn't sort of a binary up or down

[01:10:41] that if it was like sent back sent back with our direction of identifying you know where there were some um either issues problems or areas of agnes that needed clarification in which to approve and then which point it comes back into the system so maybe that's maybe that's technically a second review

maybe it's just coming back in through the process but um that seemed to make sense but i do i think this question that joan just raised here is important that is this uh if it's sent back is that final or is there still an opportunity to get technical assistance and revise it and

[01:11:14] resubmit mr rocher hammer mr hansen would you like to speak for that what your views are i just again my my interest here is ensuring clarity and consensus on how best to proceed even understanding we may all vote differently on this item but the process has been set people knew what it was and if we're going to change it i want to make sure that everyone understands and i'm clear too and as the staff will be so i thank you for your patience as we deliberate on this item mr

[01:11:49] hanson and then mr roffman i would maybe ask dr armstrong for just any feedback from the last two members of the committee's uh commentary of um you know maybe just functionally how you would see it based on you know the recommendation how that would work right i do want to i feel compelled madam chair if i may to highlight one piece that i mentioned earlier that i just want to make sure the committee also is clear one and i know i think deb's back on the

[01:12:25] line if the committee wishes to get her opinion on this that's fine but the virginia board of education approved guidelines for how and i literally have this in my hand for submission approval of laboratory school applications i'm reading this verbatim states that representatives of the entity who submit the application attend a meeting with the standing committee at the meeting with the standing committee the representatives are asked to discuss the contents of the application address the standing committee's questions it then goes on to say that following public comment or public hearing conducted by the standing committee and the meeting with the applicant the standing committee will prepare a report to the full board with the

[01:13:02] standing committee's recommendation and that a copy will be provided to the applicant and then really the next step is that is action by the board and that the board in the approved boe guidelines really has more flexibility to conduct review than the standing committee per what's written here they have the option to either decide that it beats the board's approval criteria or to render a decision that does not provide the app with an opportunity addressing deficiencies i feel and again i'm not the attorney here that the standing committee has is somewhat

[01:13:42] almost subsumed the processes that the state board has as it's written in the board approved guidelines and as a as an agency staff member who has to work by the the letter of the law here i just do feel compelled to to put that out there too i know it's been mentioned that this is a recommendation and by the letter of these guidelines it is and but again you know ultimately this is the standing committee's meeting and you all will take action this item but i did feel compelled to just make that clear from the document that was approved by the state board

[01:14:15] armstrong thank you and i just um also would like to just really reiterate that the standing committee has provided and will continue to provide such an important role in helping to launch this program and to ensure its accountability ensure that there's the technical assistance and the partnership that is uh needed and to get the quality outcomes that we all are looking for for especially our our students and i i think maybe that last point that dr armstrong made is important

[01:14:54] you know as the state board we um you know take upon first and final review a lot you know things like the school construction grants that are coming through the pipeline they don't have a secondary sense of um you know expertise and engagement uh that these grant applicants do um and so

you know when this committee was set up uh you know these could have all just been handled as you know direct grants to applications to the department and i think we need to really

[01:15:34] keep in mind that you know the board felt it important to establish this committee to you know help bring in outside public expertise which we have on this committee with the three non-state board members and as well as the process and the openness that we've you know been running you know throughout this process across the state and with all of the stakeholders involved in this so i i think if anything we have had a double triple quadruple measure of accountability and

[01:16:09] oversight and of ensuring of a quality outcome of you know just with the creation and the work of this committee and so i just think you know comments like closing down process or things like that i just don't i think if anything we are again as i said before you know evolving the process streamlining the process and where the ultimate accountability is with the board and again just the this committee has just provided the commonwealth with an incredible amount of

[01:16:48] assurance and uh help that uh you know we really are um having quality uh grants quality uh leading to quality outcomes uh here so i i just think it's important to keep that in mind too of really the role that we're playing in supporting uh the state board uh mr rotherham and yeah i'm gonna just actually mr rotherham i'm gonna just wait because i'm gonna see if dr moran or mr bailey have anything else then i'll do my come back around the horn for the thirds and then i think

[01:17:22] we'll bring this one on home for a vote is that acceptable to you sir okay dr moran or mr bailey yeah nothing else thank you sir i would just i would just ask once again that if we can put an an asterisk on that first review that says it's possible we may send this back to the department for a second review into a second review process that that would that would take me to a different place versus just having it look like that it ends at first review because I think it addresses

[01:17:57] what you're saying which is that I don't want to vote no I'd like to be able to to have these proposals get the support and go through the process if they need to and there are some that are coming to us that we may say today, let's send it on. And I'm good with that. But I don't want to leave out a piece of process that gets people something that they need to then get back to the place where they can go to the state board. I really appreciate that. And I just, it seems

[01:18:31] though that the state board has that same ability to kick it back if need be. And to me, that is again uh kind of the governor here of um ensuring uh you know that we get what we ultimately need and you know so you know i i agree that there needs to be you know some opportunity and so i appreciated your comments initially too but i i do believe that the way the process works that you know the state board can also do that but i i believe we can do that at any point in the process and the point i wanted to make so pam i i hear you and like i agree that that's like

[01:19:11] there's nothing in here that's setting up some sort of path dependence where you move the committee can decide it's not i mean we're going to be leaning more on the department which i think is appropriate as um as as dr armstrong said we're gonna uh make that process a little more robust up front and and lean on them a little bit more but we can send it back we can send it back with conditions we the state board can do that and applicants then have a choice okay i want to address those conditions and come back and we have examples that we have an example of that today or they can decide no okay that's what they're asking for um that's not something that we want

[01:19:47] to do as part of this program and and you know we can't put anybody through this you know um again against their will so i i hear you uh dr moran i think we are i think we are covered on that because at every point people need to do their job the staff as dr armstrong laid out us at this point in the process and then the state board um when these things uh when these things do reach the state board whether that's on a first review or whether that's something that's been sent back i think it's important that the state board doesn't if it gets sent back once or even twice decide oh this is good the state board has to do its its diligence as well supported by staff so

[01:20:25] i hear your point i'm comfortable though that we that we have that uh that we have that incorporated uh just by just a matter of like the process of each of these each of these public institutions as these uh move through and i call the question that's the first time we've ever had to call a question on this committee oh my goodness yes yes but we have a lot of uh waiting on this call who i'm sure are riveted by this debate um i have no doubt they're on the edge of their seats but uh they're they're here so we can talk about their schools i think i had already indicated that's

[01:20:59] exactly where we were gonna go so all right all those in favor of first of approving on first and final an amendment to the college partnership laboratory school process please indicate by saying aye aye aye aye those opposed the same nay for my for the chair and nay for dr moran i believe yes no no okay uh the motion passes three to two we'll now proceed with item e first and final

[01:21:39] review of the college partnership laboratory school application from enri and henry um dr armstrong is going to present a quick overview on this item and then we will hear from emory and henry because we saw them at our march meeting i am expecting a more truncated presentation last time they presented their full presentation to us fantastic today they will just be speaking to the items that were changed based on feedback from the committee dr armstrong madam chair i apologize do we need

[01:22:11] to go back to the item where we were asking for uh oh yeah is miss love here i apologize for stepping away it's like you know the doctor in the theater right you're just waiting to be called they're a doctor in the house and i missed my cue i apologize please proceed so um just for clarity's sake i want to make sure i'm this is on the question of the eligibility of private institutions of higher education to participate in the process um so this is this is a really straightforward analysis um

[01:22:52] the definition of college partnership laboratory school in um in the statute in the naming legislation for this program says that it's a the eligible the institutions that are eligible to establish such schools um include um eligible institutions as defined in another statute and that statute which relates to the tag grant program which offers uh certain tuition subsidies

[01:23:31] for virginia students going to virginia private institutions for education makes clear that uh private institutions of higher education are eligible not only to participate in the tag grant program but then our eligible institutions under um for the college laboratory school program as i think i've put this in writing i think that has been shared with you all am i correct in that and miss love i think it'd be beneficial for what was shared with the committee members i i

[01:24:05] maybe maybe did that come in this morning to us again all right well all right so i'll back up so we have in state law a definition of college partnership laboratory schools um this um and the definition i apologize for reading this stuff um people who are not lawyers shouldn't have to hear statutes read but the definition of lab school means a public non-sectarian non-religious school in the commonwealth

established by a public institution of higher education all right we're familiar with that a public higher education center institute or

[01:24:44] authority so new college institute for example or an eligible institution as defined in a statute in title 23.1 which is our educational institution statute so we have three classes that are set out here in this definition of lab schools as being able to establish eligible to establish a lab school the public institutions of higher education the public higher ed centers and eligible institutions as defined elsewhere in the code so we turn over to that other

[01:25:21] definition to understand what is meant by an eligible institution and this that definition means it is a non-profit hot private institution of higher education whose primary purpose is to provide collegiate graduate or professional education and not to provide religious training your theological education so that would be your own colleges your emory and henry's not your virginia theological seminary in alexandria for example so that definition is captured from

[01:25:57] title 23 brought in to incorporate it into the definition of lab schools that are public schools established by one of those three categories of institutions which include these privates thank you bispo and i'm going to remind the committee members if they have questions which i'm happy to entertain you do need to go into closed session if they want to deliberate on this we would need to go into closed session so quick show of hands does anyone have a question for miss love okay we can stay an open session all right miss love thank you very much for the briefing i

[01:26:36] very much appreciate it um with this time we're going to go toggle back to item c which is e excuse me which is emery and every really old c i forgot the old agenda um item e dr armstrong should we just go to emory and henry they've been waiting patiently let them present five minutes of the changes they've made based on the last committee meeting yes ma'am and madam chair if you in the committee will indulge me for a moment what i would like to do with your blessing is to instead of giving my overview ahead of each of our six applicants i can give a broad overview

[01:27:13] now and get that through and then we'll be able to roll through our applicants if that's okay i love economies of scale let's do it okay and i i appreciate everyone's understanding with this but i didn't want to give a little more details we go into this madam chair committee members i would like to provide this brief overview on behalf of the agency one of six lab school applications before you for review today these applicants represent a diversity and geographic target area of the commonwealth student experience and workforce focus and scale of both higher Education and K-12 Partner Divisions. You will find cover sheets on the first pages of each attached

[01:27:51] application from the Office of the Attorney General and the VDOE Policy Innovation and Instruction Teams. These sign-offs are a result of months of work on behalf of the applicants, the agency, and the OAG to ensure that you are presented with complete and compliant applications.

[01:28:06] In addition, all applicants have worked with the VDOE and Governor's Transformation Team to thoughtfully refine their budgets to ensure overall efficiency while not sacrificing the unique experience the lab school provide on behalf of the students, teachers, parents, and communities surrounding each lab school. All applicants have confirmed receipt of the sustainability checklist indicating their ongoing plans to engage funding from among K-12 philanthropic grant, higher ed institution, business, industry, and fundraising sources, and the VDOE stands ready to work alongside the Secretary of Education to continue to support the efforts of our lab schools toward full sustainability

[01:28:44] past the four-year grant spend window. While I will allow each applicant to expand details in their presentations, as you know Emory & Henry's Southwest Virginia Heals Academy will engage students toward high-skill healthcare careers with dual enrollment and on-site opportunities at Emory & Henry Southwest Virginia Higher Ed Center, Virginia Highlands Community College, and Whitfield Community College. They have made revisions responsive to DOE and standing committee review to address concerns related to dual enrollment prerequisites, IHE employer requirements, and making the HEALS Academy open to all students in the Commonwealth.

[01:29:18] Emory & Henry is partnering with Bristol City, Washington County, Smith County, Wythe County, and the Libwyn Holden's Governor's School. Their application is complete and compliant. Georgia Mason's Access Academy will be your second application for consideration, and their proposal also returns to the standing committee, this time partnering with Loudoun County Public schools for their Accelerated College and Employability Skills, or ACCESS Academy. This is a lab school designed to support the transition of at-risk learners into college and high-demand careers with a preliminary focus on information technology. And in later years, after ACCESS

[01:29:53] is established, they intend to begin operations in 2025. The lab school will scale up to partner with other school division stakeholders and expand focus on educational and healthcare career Pathways. This is a partnership among George Mason University, Northern Virginia Community College, and as mentioned, Loudoun County Public Schools. Roanoke Colleges Explore at RC Lab School will be your third for consideration. This is a partnership with Salem City Schools and features three career-oriented pathways, education and global studies, STEM and healthcare, and communications and civic engagement. Courses are inquiry-based and provide dual enrollment credit. Examples of

[01:30:31] courses include Introduction to Public Health, Chemistry and Crime, and Principles of Education. This will culminate in a senior capstone with project-based learning and field work related to their career pathway, and they tie directly to workforce needs in the Roanoke region. This will set students up for success in their chosen pathway through their real-world learning opportunities. They will also have the unique opportunity, like most lab school students across the Commonwealth, to experience the critical exposure of class attendance on the Roanoke college campus. Pau D. Camp Community College will be your fourth for consideration. They have

[01:31:05] developed the Isle Maritime Trades Academy, IMTA, to provide a high school to college to work pipeline and a partnership among Pau D. Community College, Isle of White County Public Schools, and their initial corporate partner Huntington Ingalls Industries Newport News Shipbuilding.

[01:31:21] The overall goal of IMTA is to graduate students who possess in-demand technical and workplace ready skills for middle skill jobs with Newport News Shipbuilding and similar employers and to position themselves in pathways that provide options for advancement with additional education or training. Our last two applications before you today are from Old Dominion University. The first is a partnership with Newport News Public Schools to propose the Maritime Engineering and Environmental Studies Academy, or MESA. The lab school will focus heavily on student-guided learning through STEM experiential learning, guided inquiry, design thinking, career and technical

[01:31:56] education, as well as internships and job shadowing opportunities. Mesa will align with education, research, and innovation efforts at ODU around maritime, as well as with the Virginia Digital Maritime Center, an initiative designed to enhance the region's maritime workforce, particularly through

digital innovation. And then ODU will round us out with their proposal that partners with Chesapeake City Schools to propose the Computer Science Lab School CSLS at Oscar Smith middle which is our second middle school lab school proposal for your review csls is designed to prepare students for the technology talent pipeline and also to increase the number of k-12

[01:32:35] teachers prepared to teach computer science in support of that pipeline csls will develop a complete program of study focused on computer science and a regional focus that aligns to workforce needs in addition to exposure and experience of programming concepts through various coding languages the prospective program of study will integrate the current academies that are in place in Chesapeake City. As I mentioned, all these applications contained a cover sheet from OBG and the agency that assures their completeness and compliance for your consideration. And Madam Chair, I will leave it to you to have Emory and Henry take it away

[01:33:10] with their brief presentation. Thank you, Dr. Armstrong. At this time, we'd like to welcome Mr. Lee and Dr. Fincher from Emory and Henry College. They will briefly speak to the committee and just as a reminder kind of the same efficiency for all lab applicants that we will consider today what we will do is we will take once we take up your application we will hear your formal presentation before the committee asks any questions i will ask you if there are any other members of the public or any other members that are partners in your application that would like

[01:33:45] to speak to your application and you at that time you will be invited to introduce yourself state your name state your title state your role any comments that you may have and we will absolutely welcome all those comments as we have in all of our prior committee meetings as well your support and collaboration with these last schools is incredibly important we want to make sure that you have an opportunity to note that for the record so with that mr lee and mr fincher please proceed or dr fincher my apologies thank you madam chair and if it's appropriate at this

[01:34:18] time i will share our screen with our powerpoint thank you are you all able to see that fine we can see it thank you i am joined uh in our conference room this morning with as you said danny lee who is the director executive director of our heels program and mike davidson who is the assistant director of our heels program so madam chair and lab school standing committee members we are

[01:34:57] certainly pleased to be on your agenda this afternoon and to have the opportunity to present to you our revised application for the Southwest Virginia Healthcare Excellence Academy Lab School or as we refer to it the HEALS program. I also want to thank Dr. Armstrong for his work in helping us to revise our application and in preparing our presentation today and we will skip through many of these slides because you have as you have said madam chair you have seen many of these before i would just say to remind you again we have a very strong collaborative partnership and

[01:35:37] we do have the majority of our partners represented on this meeting today that we'll introduce as you said at a later time after our presentation we have already shared with you our mission and our vision i would just again say our vision is to create an academic pipeline a sustainable academic pipeline for preparing future health care professionals to serve the workforce needs in our region. Our primary goal again is still to increase the number of high school students that graduate from southwest Virginia who choose to serve as health care providers in our southwest Virginia area. Our program is open to any student in the commonwealth

[01:36:17] who has an interest in pursuing a career in health care. We will specifically target 10th through 12th grade students in our K-12 partner institutions. Our academic program is a rigorous program that includes both dual and concurrent enrollment courses. They're sequenced and scaffolded to provide foundational sciences, introductory healthcare content, healthcare career exploration, and one of the key features that we think is so key to our program is the experiential opportunities that students have in a career-based setting. All of our teachers who

[01:36:54] teach in the HEALS program will hold a valid teaching license and all will be employed by Emory & Henry College. Any student who is enrolled in Southwest Virginia HEALS program will be provided the support to engage in the rigorous dual and concurrent enrollment courses. Just again our pathways we have six pathways in health care and our courses again spread over the 10th through 12th grade years again they're scaffolding from foundational sciences up through very focused career pathway courses and again we believe the highlight is the experiential opportunities that

[01:37:33] they have in the hospital and other health care settings from 10th grade up through 12th grade our instructional sites as a reminder include the higher ed center in abington virginia on our southern end and our emory and henry college health sciences campus on our northern end our program is a cohort model our bristol and washington county cohorts would would feed into for the most part the higher ed center whereas our smith and with cohorts would feed into our emory and henry health sciences campus and transportation is provided by our partnering school

[01:38:08] divisions just a reminder our program is a half day program with classes in the morning on those health care campuses our estimated enrollment remains the same we expect in year one which is your academic year 24 25 to have 50 sophomores and 50 juniors for a total of 100 students with year two through four or year two beyond having 150 students with 50 within each grade we've provided an additional budget spreadsheet using the template that was provided by

[01:38:46] the BDOE and what is highlighted or circled in red just shows the amount that we would be requesting in funding from the BDOE with year zero being the startup year 1.2 represents the 200,000 in planning grant as well as the 1 million in startup funds within a request in year one to be seven hundred thousand and if you look up slightly you'll see that the cost per pupil amount would be six thousand nine hundred and ninety nine and then for years two through four request funding of one

[01:39:21] million and fifty thousand which again the per pupil funding cost is a few rows up above that below as requested we provided projections for our sustainability in funding which we'll speak to next and related to sustainability emory and henry college is fully committed to engaging our partners from among local school divisions higher education institutions our businesses industry philanthropic and grant funding agencies to ensure that there is sustainability for

[01:39:58] the heels program beyond the four-year lab school grant funding additionally emory and henry will engage our institutional resources to provide continued in-kind support and potential funding to sustain lab school operations beyond the four-year lab school grant funding we have worked very closely with our partners and we included in our our revised application statement on sustainability plan and that's an appendix r which outlines it much more in detail but in working with our partnering school divisions who have committed to the success of the southwest virginia

[01:40:36] Hills program. They have demonstrated their willingness to examine a per-people fee which could be providing in addition to their transportation in kind could assist with instructional supplies and

instructional materials technology and and such. The Linwood-Holton Governor's School is fully committed to the program and and can provide support in terms of dual enrollment tuition assistance and we would be employing some of the faculty that currently teach in their program for them to also teach in the HEALS program. Emory & Henry College has pledged

[01:41:15] support of our staffing needs. We and Southwest Higher Education Center are providing in-kind support in our facilities which include classroom spaces, lab spaces, technology, and support services. We've created an advisory council, in fact we just met with our advisory council earlier today who have worked with us in identifying additional philanthropic groups who would be supportive of our educational endeavors related to the health care career and this council has assisted us in identifying multiple agencies and those were listed in bold wellspring foundation

[01:41:54] of southwest virginia and the smith county community foundation we included in our application letters of support we have met with them they have encouraged us to submit applications for funding their funding are on annual cycles so it would it would be too soon to apply for funding now for year five but they have highly encouraged us to submit funding applications and we are in the process of setting meetings with the Clyde Moore Foundation Bill Gatton Foundation with Bland Foundation and it and actually just today heard more about the possibility of the Go Virginia

[01:42:30] initiative having a focus on health care so we continue to develop those relationships and feel like we have a very strong plan that would result in what we believe would be approximately 700 000 at the minimum of grant monies coming in when we meet when we need that in year five and we will continue to apply for grant funding even before we need it there for year five with that i would would ask if you have any questions and again thank you for the opportunity to present

[01:43:05] our revised application thank you for being here let me are there any additional individuals engaged in your application that are here today that would like to introduce themselves and address the committee yes madam chair let me stop sharing my screen we have multiple representatives from our partnering institutions would you like for me to introduce them all at one time and then have them open up to share comments or to introduce them and then share

[01:43:39] comments and then we introduce the next one um if they know who they are they can introduce themselves and if not then i like your idea let's have them introduce you introduce everyone and then they can you know introduce themselves and make their remark i want to make sure that we get your whole team though on record okay so uh present at this meeting uh we have dennis carter who is superintendent for the Smith County Public Schools. We have Wes Poole, who is superintendent for the Wythe County Public Schools. David Scott, superintendent for the Bristol County Public

[01:44:16] Schools. David Matlock, who is the director of the Southwest Virginia Higher Education Center. Mike Pugliese, who is provost and executive vice president for Emory and Henry College. Dean Sprinkle, who is president of Wytheville Community College. And Mike Robinson, who is director of the a linwood holton governor school i'm a baseball mom so hopefully everybody heard the batting order and we're going to go to uh who's up at plate right now dennis i just want to say thank you for the opportunity to be here today to present the plan again and thank you for

[01:44:55] the opportunity to make the adjustments that were needed and we're excited to move forward with this project thank you wes uh yes thank you for this opportunity uh we're excited we have a number of students already there and hopefully we are successful in the application like my colleagues just wanted

to say thank you for the opportunity to let us bring this back in front of you i think it's a an awesome opportunity for us to expand opportunities for our students without having

[01:45:32] to take on uh you know the overhead costs that could be a deterrent otherwise allowing us to spread that among many partners is very beneficial and i'm very pleased we got to present again thank you david matlock yes thank you so much i'm david malach i'm agency head executive director of the southwest virginia higher education center i just want to say thank you again and i just want to say that on behalf of the 10 colleges universities that offer post-secondary programs here at the southwest virginia education center and my chairman senator pillion uh we stand behind this uh program

[01:46:08] and we'll do whatever is necessary to be successful for our region thank you again for letting us address the committee this afternoon just on behalf of emery and henry college i want to affirm that emery and henry is firmly committed to the sustainability of the heels program beyond the funding cycle and in the ways that was that were indicated in the presentation and in the supporting documentation that emery and henry is fully committed to the success of the heels lab school

[01:46:43] dean sprickell uh again to echo our quality i appreciate this opportunity but uh the third i'd add is that i think it's another opportunity for us to build on what we already have is a very strong track record and collaboration in southwest virginia and i know we're all fully committed to making this a success so thank you again and mike robinson yes thank you for the committee's consideration of this application we're excited and looking forward to being approved and moving

[01:47:20] forward this is a an opportunity for kids in our region to really benefit from a tremendous opportunity that doesn't exist currently and so i'm i'm hopeful and anxious and excited about the possibilities and that's our our team thank you ma'am at this time we'll go to questions or comments from members of the standing committee i'll be very brief mr rotherham there you go i be very brief i think this is great i'm glad to see you back um the health aspect of it was particularly

[01:47:58] resident to me when you first uh came before us it's it's highly needed and i'm really excited about we talked about having a diversity of schools and creating different kinds of opportunities this is a great example so i'm extremely excited to see you all go forward mr bailey yeah i just wanted to say the same i appreciate all the extra work you did on the application and the improvements on it really appreciate all the effort that went into it and just share um andy's shared passion and interest in this it's not not just the diversity of schools and you're tackling health

[01:48:33] care but it's the diversity of health care uh fields too and uh there's just huge shortages uh especially behavior health and a number of these other fields and so you know giving students a pathway early to be able to explore that and build some confidence um it's just going to be so important not just to the students but to the communities they're going to end up serving so thank you for that. Mr. Hanson? I don't have anything to add. Just a mutual thank you. Dr. Moran?

[01:49:06] Dr. Moran, you're on mute. There we go. I'm thrilled with this proposal because of the, and I've seen this happen in Southwest Virginia school districts before divisions when they come together and just really leverage themselves up to do things that otherwise perhaps as individuals they could not do. Seeing what I would call full-bodied community support from both the higher education community as well as partnerships with folks in the health and medical sciences fields, I really, really value and appreciate. So I see this and also the statement from

[01:49:45] the president about his commitment on behalf of Emory & Henry. One of the best science educators I ever worked with was a graduate of Emory and Henry. It's a wonderful school and has educated a lot of teachers across the Commonwealth really well to serve our kids.

[01:50:04] So it's great to see them stepping up to be a partner in this and to have a sustainability commitment. I do have one area that I have still some angst about in the actual application in regards to looking for specific kids, and it sort of triggered for me because I had to go through the whole process in establishing charter schools, what it looks like to be sure that all students are given a full opportunity to hear about alternative options for them in public

[01:50:42] education in the concept of whether it's an academy, a lab school, or a charter school, and being focused on that we do not signal to kids that there are some kids that are a tier above others. And in opening a governor's school for health and medical sciences academy at Monticello High School, I saw some kids who were not particularly motivated in the regular education program in high school become highly motivated students when they were able to become a part of the Health and Medical Sciences Academy. In the proposal, there's some language here that gave me

[01:51:20] some angst, and I'm wondering if perhaps this could be something that before this, if voted forward, goes to the board that, again, might receive some modification. It's a statement, I think it's on page 13 in the actual PDF that enrolled students will be future health care providers who demonstrate college readiness and the motivation and dedication to complete a rigorous dual enrollment program. I could see counselors latching onto that and some kids getting more

[01:51:55] attention to being boosted into a pool and hopefully you'll end up needing to do a lottery because you'll have too many kids that want to be in your program that you actually have. But is it possible to make sure that that language does not become a driver that specifically sorts and selects kids as this program is being brought forward?

[01:52:21] Because it's my understanding, looking at state code, that if parents have an interest and the student has an interest and they do the application, they end up in the pool. and I wouldn't want to see some kids potentially in and others out based on someone's perception of their motivation and dedication because if they've never experienced a program like this but they want to be in it I want them to have that opportunity and not get sorted out and I would be happy to address that and thank you for bringing that point forward and we took the feedback from the committee when we met with you in March and we have met with our counselors as well as our

[01:52:58] curriculum committee and all of our partners and it has been clearly communicated that our program is open to all students and that was one reason why we particularly added on our slides and I know I went through them quickly but but one it's open to all students and we will be providing the academic support to help students be successful in the rigorous curriculum. The curriculum is rigorous because that's what's needed to move into those college programs but it is open and we will be we anticipate with year this year coming up that we will be using the lottery because we will

[01:53:34] have more applications than what we can accept dr fincher how are you so for the benefit of the committee and i'm i do want to make my remarks on your application here in a moment in anticipation that we might have some feedback from uh our committee members on applications and knowing that we would probably have to consider them on first and final review today here's what i'm

going to put forward for the committee's consideration and in terms of how i'd like to proceed on these and see if see if i can get a consensus agreement on this um i'm going to listen to the discussion

[01:54:10] up from the committee members here if there's any concerns and then develop a consensus-based motion that would incorporate the feedback of the standing committee members if possible to complement our review move the application forward to the state board with the recommendations and feedback and it might look something such as the you know this is the first and final motion to approve applicant x with a contingency that the following areas are addressed if that's agreeable

[01:54:45] to the standing committee because what i'm trying to get away from is you know straight up and downs on some of these um then we can incorporate the feedback from dr moran it sounds like dr fincher saying that you've heard that feedback you'll continue to refine and work to that feedback you're working with your uh guidance counselors and teachers to understand that feedback i think what um dr moran and i'll include myself in those remarks as well we're looking for just a greater assurance that the program really is open to all students and that support would be offered for all students to be successful in the program so i think there's good alignment i hear that that's

[01:55:22] your intention um so i don't feel like this necessarily be a demonstrative change but we do want to make sure that it's clarified for the record if the standing committee members can live with that kind of first final with some notation which i believe i heard mr rotherham you suggest and that would go into our report and i'm hoping that maybe we can move through these is there any objection to that from a committee member i just want to madam chair and i am also in assisting the standing committee preparing that report i'm

[01:55:56] documenting all of the feedback as well perfect thank you dr armstrong i always appreciate the administrative support okay all right so that is noted um those two elements i've noted that down promotion um and but i want to first say for emery and henry your application is amazing i am i am so impressed with and it is so clear that you have spent a considerable amount of time i'm impressed with your collaboration with the local school divisions and your school board chairs and the letters that we have with ballard health your chamber of commerce even the additional letters that have been supplied from the wellspring foundation as well as the smith county foundation

[01:56:36] and when i look at your proposal you've addressed in your remarks the sustainability issue but you also have five years from now nearly 40 of the funds that you'll need in year five which is an impressive mark and i want to thank you for doing that it speaks to the commitment from both the institution as well as they really are planning ahead and you're serious about the work so i want to thank you for being so responsive to the committee's feedback for really taking that to heart and for collaborating with us to get to this point in the process so without further ado i think what i'm going to suggest is is there a motion to approve on first

[01:57:15] and final emory and henry's application to post the application for a 10-day public comment period contingent that the following areas including recruitment of students to ensure that it is open to all students and to ensure that support is available to all students is addressed by the applicant to conform with state law prior to the deliberation by the state board of education so moved their second second mr bailey all those in favor of the motion please signify by saying

[01:57:51] aye aye aye free process the chair votes aye as well any in the opposition please signify by saying may the motion passes unanimously and congratulations to emory and henry we will now proceed

with item f i'm going to just check in with our standing committee members and dr armstrong since we've been going strong for two hours should we take like a 10 minute recess five minute recess and come back before five minute recess let's have a five minute recess before we come yeah okay five

[01:58:27] minute recess all right at 4 10 we'll come back and we'll proceed everybody gets a six minute

[01:58:34] recess all right i'm going to give everybody the one minute warning we are back from our recess

[02:04:32] thank you very much everyone for continuing on with us we're now going to take up item f which is first and final review of the college partnership laboratory school application from george mason university dr armstrong has already spoken to this item so at this time we'll proceed the committee will hear from dr ingrid lopez and i apologize if i'm pronouncing that correctly, my sincere apology, from George Mason University. And then we will hear from any other special guests that are here on behalf of George Mason. Please, Dr. Lopez. Good afternoon. Thank you.

[02:05:09] I believe I have to share my screen so everybody can see. Great. Well, good afternoon. It's my pleasure to be here on behalf of our partners, NOVA Community College and Loudoun County Public schools to present Access Academy. We have been here once before, but we're really thrilled with the very strong partnership that we have here today. Our Accelerated College and Employability Academy is really focused on providing innovative educational experiences to high school students who've traditionally perhaps not found the kind of pathways that really meet their needs. And so

[02:05:49] what's really unique about this is that it is both meant to provide access to high demand, well-compensated careers early on in their high school career, while at the same time helping them work through a two and four year degree, because as research shows, that's still really important for a lifetime of earning potential and a good quality of life. Some of the innovative aspects of our model is the problem-based learning curriculum. And so in the IT curriculum that they'll receive at George Mason, it's really going to be redesigned from an actual

[02:06:28] problem-based set of scenarios. One of the many ways in which our industry partners will collaborate with us will be precisely to get involved in those real-life work scenarios. The other thing that's really unique about the model is this idea of employability skills. Employability skills are going to be really critical regardless of disciplinary focus for all of our young students in the workplace. Things like system thinking, critical thinking, collaboration, those are transferable. So regardless of their career trajectory, those are the skill sets that employers

[02:07:02] are looking for globally. So that will also position them for a lifetime of good careers and and strong earning potential. In addition to that, we really want to work with a competency-based education framework, which really means that in addition to just thinking about knowledge and facts and concepts, that we do have an anchored approach into actual measurable, demonstrable skill sets. So it'll be behavioral competencies and performance-based assessments that help us uh really get a sense of of the skill development of our students um also there's a learn and earn

[02:07:42] model so as you'll see in the next slide when i present a little bit more uh of detail into the model that there is a paid internship component so that again students are seeing themselves in that environment that they develop this identity with this it focus to to start with as as being very uh natural to

them so a lot of this is also developing the identity within the career uh environment as well as within the higher ed environment so what you see here is that for each

[02:08:18] of the years each of the high school years they are getting a sort of more in in a continuum they're really developing more and more additional elements of the program so they start in the freshman year really with introductory kinds of experiences to employability skills of course we'll be providing technical assistance to train teachers to provide professional development and problem-based learning but also to help start to integrate employability skills in the regular

[02:08:51] curriculum and also working with them as much as possible to integrate these concepts into regular division programming and as much as possible also begin to bring in our industry partners to introduce them to the potential of these careers as we know with technology a lot of the careers that are going to be available or in demand even three years from now we don't have a full appreciation of so that relationship with the industry partners there will be a career coach that's going to be really well aligned to industry partner needs will

[02:09:30] continuously be providing that that that guidance for our students and for the curriculum as well as we go into the junior and senior years that's when the dual enrollment courses will be available of course piggybacking off things like advanced and other models starting in their junior year they can take up to 30 credit hours towards a college degree. Yeah, 30 credit hours towards a college degree. And for those students who, you know, for many probably don't really think about college or their opportunities up until that last year, we want to make sure that there's

[02:10:07] something available for them as well. So with the development of a bridge program to really get them into an expedited program and introduction to problem-based learning, the idea would be that they could take up to 15 credit hours towards a college degree in addition to experiences through the on-the-job paid senior internship. The other piece that's really unique for both the junior and the senior year is that they have an intensive immersive kind of research experience at our

[02:10:43] campus, our FEWS campus, and so the idea there is for our students to work side by side not only with industry partners, but also with researchers in sort of a very developmental think tech kind of space. Obviously, collaborations and partnerships are really important for us. We have a number of industry partners that are going to be collaborating in different ways through, as I mentioned before, the actual problems and case studies that are relevant to the workplace, but also providing

[02:11:17] internship, mentorship, site visits, and also early in the 9th and 10th grades also coming as guest speakers and presenters. Within the university setting, we are working across different colleges, certainly College of Education and Human Development, but also with our IT faculty. We're going to be redesigning the curriculum and make sure that we're integrating research and innovation into into our teaching one of the things that's really important for us is to ensure that we are collecting data that there is a strong research and evaluation component

[02:11:56] so that we have a sense of of what are the aspects of this design that really will work well and for whom and under what conditions with the hope of scaling up in subsequent years based on that learning and then of course in terms of a a total learning ecosystem for our students we are working from high school all the way through our community college and our uh george mason four-year degree uh partnership so i realize our our partner uh from leon county uh is here uh i think that uh there was a group of three folks we might have uh somebody here who would like to chime in on the

[02:12:35] student population perhaps wonderful we'd be happy to welcome uh please say your name title us hi there thank you my name is actually academic officer here in downtown public school i'm joined by dr daniel smith our chief of staff and our superintendent dr aaron spence had to step out for another commitment but he did want us to pass along his support and our board support for this lab school application and we wanted to talk very briefly about the student population

[02:13:10] while any student residing in the commonwealth may apply to the access academy we are also focused on starting at-risk students including those who have historically been underrepresented in their access to high and well-compensated careers such as information technology we are planning for 30 students in each grade grades 9 through 12 beginning year one in the fall of 2025. The foundational elements of this academy will be taught in grades 9 and 10 as students provided initial exposure to the concept of problem-based learning, employability skills,

[02:13:48] and a variety of IT career fields and pathways. Once students enter that 11th grade year in the Access Academy the structure of their day would change as they'll attend all day at the Loudoun NOVA Community College campus and at the George Mason University Fuse Center and it's in these spaces that our 11th and 12th graders will work alongside higher education faculty, industry experts, and mentors to really tackle real-world problems by applying appropriate theoretical frameworks, designing prototypes, and assessing the impact of those solutions. We're really excited about the 15 credit hours of dual enrollment coursework that is planned for both the 11th

[02:14:27] and 12th grade years of the program with students potentially earning over 30 credit hours upon graduation from the access academy and so that's a little bit about our student population what we have planned i'll now turn it back over to dr guerrero lopez to share what a day in the life at the access academy for a student might look like at both the louden nova community college campus and the george mason university fuse center thank you daniel so as you can see we we actually we have a couple of scenarios because we do have the regular, you know, school day scenario, but then we also have that immersive experience at FUSE. But really, the learning experience

[02:15:05] begins on a daily basis with a clear problem to solve, and it requires a lot of collaboration as well. So the idea here is for them to really apply the concepts that are key to information technologies, but to do it in an authentic environment where it's really recalling on relevant concepts, the application of the right ideas, the right concepts at the right time for the right problem. So there's quite a bit of analysis development. There's quite a bit of collaboration with peers and the sharing of a lot of different ideas. One of the things that's

[02:15:41] really important about the model as well is this idea of near peer mentoring. And so we will have them working with postdocs, PhDs, master's students, and more progressed undergraduate students as well. But the idea is really for them to get the benefit of diverse perspectives in action, not in a purely academic environment. As we go into the day in the life at Fuse, it's again working with the research team putting forth a key project engaging the students as part

[02:16:18] of the team and really thinking through what is required and again as you can see here it's a lot of development of systems thinking and design principles all of these really key progressive kind of competencies that are in demand not just in the it environment but also in in other areas And just very quickly here, you can see that our upfront or pilot year, I guess I should say the first launch year, is about $1 million. We've received the planning grant close to $200,000,

[02:16:56] and we're expecting an annual expenditure of about $840,000 for a total of $4.559 million. what is not reflected here is the also in-kind support that George Mason is providing which equals for the same timeline over one million dollars with about two hundred thousand dollars per year of in-kind support I'm going to move and I realize we might be running a little bit over

[02:17:28] time but also for our sustainability again the partnership piece is really important here because we want to make sure that we're aligning to everybody's strategic priorities. But this idea of the monitoring and evaluation is really going to be critical for additional funding. We have a strategy for partnering with a lot of different funding agencies to continue to get funding for the school. Our industry partner, Google, has been very excited to see this proposal move forward.

[02:18:00] They have already committed 100 AI micro-credential licenses renewable for our students. In addition to that, they've committed $125,000 just to launch just because of a show of confidence in the program and are standing by with a pledge of half a million dollars for this year once approved. We expect that support to continue every year and diversify in kind and expand as well.

[02:18:27] in addition to that we've identified two national science foundation grants that are perfectly aligned to the goals of the lab school with a potential to obtain funding between one and two million dollars for the next three to five years and so we also have a development team that stands ready to once approved really move this concrete concept forward to our donors who are also very eager to invest in this idea and we really are excited to be able to provide something that has the potential to really change

[02:19:04] the lives of our students in the commonwealth so thank you for your attention and with that i think i'll hand it over to you okay thank you is there anyone else from george mason university or from your community that you would like to speak to the application prior to us taking on questions or comments from the expanding committee that would be great i would ask our partner from nova community college to introduce herself first and then Kami and Kim wonderful welcome hi there can you hear me all right yes my name is Kristen Carter I'm the associate director of dual

[02:19:40] enrollment at Northern Virginia Community College thank you for this opportunity and your consideration of the application we're definitely excited for the collaboration moving forward good evening director Institute for Digital Innovation George Mason University i'm super excited for this collaboration uh we know that this is a unique way for students to not only do immersive learning with the industry partners um who are going to be

[02:20:11] working with them mentoring them and so on so thank you thank you thank you both for being here all right at this time i'm going to go to the standing committee members let's start with questions or comments mr hansen again not a question but just again thank you for your ongoing efforts here. I appreciate the time we spent previously and just really as a, again, George Mason alumnus and also in my prior life working in partnership with a major grant with

[02:20:50] NOVA and George Mason on dual enrollment and transfer credit and other issues. I just really, I'm just very pleased with the work that you've done. I love the competency-based and also the um you know credit uh opportunities for for the high school students to just really commend you for uh your work on this and uh really excited to uh to see where it takes us and the students

[02:21:18] that you're able to to help and support thank you i'll just echo bill that was really um impressed with all the uh the adjustments and improvements and just also the vision love the competency base really

love all the student supports that you're giving them the wraparound services the success coaches and that's just it feels so important right now with so much of the challenges that young people are are wrestling with and so i think we're going to learn a lot about your model just in general but also i'm like really excited what we can learn from that and how that could be applied

[02:21:58] to other schools as well so thank you for that mr rotham yeah i would just look um mason is a fantastic institution in the state i want to just first of all commend them for for leading on this and and leaning into this opportunity to create this school i'm excited about it as well in particular we're hearing a lot in the northern virginia tech community about you know pipelines where are people going to come from how are kids going to even learn about these opportunities and sort of navigate towards them and this is a fantastic example of people taking advantage of

[02:22:34] the opportunity we've um that we've tried to create here and to actually lead into that problem so I commend you. Dr. Moran. I love that you have so many contemporary what I would call signature practices to help move students forward that perhaps sometimes don't get those opportunities that will help them be really prepared to build that portfolio that they need. As one superintendent in Virginia said recently that we want every student graduating from our high schools to be

[02:23:12] able to enroll, enlist, or be employed. And I think that you hit all three of those E's in the work that you've put together here. I do have probably a couple, three questions, and maybe I can ask a couple and then see if anybody else wants to jump in on it. One is that I know that you're saying that you are umbrellaing, you're tailoring this for kids that are at risk, and perhaps our Loudon staff that are present might speak to how do you define, how are you seeing yourself defining at risk in order to look at tailoring the program for students that are

[02:23:51] by the definition of that's in code, what at risk constitutes. And then the second piece that maybe is something that staff at the department might help with a little bit is that it, do you have all of the funds secured in terms of commitments to carry you through this process over the next five years? Or are you thinking that it's going to come together as you move this particular

[02:24:24] program forward? I know that Mr. Armstrong, that it says in the Excel spreadsheet that the funds are there. I just wanted to be sure that I get that verified, that there are actual commitments from philanthropics or for-profits that are seeing themselves as partnering with you in this.

[02:24:46] So those are the two areas that I'm particularly interested in. And Dr. Moran, I'll speak to just the agency portion of that. In our conversations with our applicants, as well as just our internal dialogues with our agency and the secretary's office, as we plan for sustainability for these lab schools, We do know that it's from anyone who's done fundraising, and I'm not one of those people, but I've talked to those who have, it's difficult to get dollar amount commitments before this has even been stood up.

[02:25:18] And we're seeing just fidelity with the planning and the partners. And we've heard that from other applicants today. And that's what we really look for in their sustainability. I know that all our applicants today have made those efforts so they can speak that in more detail.

[02:25:35] - Would you like me to follow up just a bit more on that? I would echo that, and I would say that we do have current partnerships already standing by to be leveraged for this. Kami, you might want to talk just about the two partnerships that we have with the AI Scholars, for example. Yes, so we have two programs that are going on, both under umbrella of AI Scholars. One is supported by Air Force Office of

Scientific Research, through which we are not only preparing students on AI skills, but also giving them scholarships,

[02:26:07] So which is basically employability is there, like, you know, they don't have to look for work during summer, but they get scholarship as stipends, which definitely, you know, we encourage them to use it towards their educational purposes. And the other one that we have is we are sub-awarding of a grant, which is under CDAO, Chief AI.

[02:26:29] It's under DOD. So they gave funding to a company, Trenching Analytics, and we are awarded under that. And that is also the same model where they're working on Raspberry Pi's, working on sensors, collecting data, and then now they're assessing them.

[02:26:45] So I would just summarize by saying that our strategy is really to diversify a lot of different funding sources and as a higher ed institution we have a lot of access to national science foundation a lot of other funding agencies in a wealth in addition to the team of development officers at the college level but also at the university level uh to your first question uh i don't know if our loudon uh county partners want to chime in on the at-risk definition and how we operationalize that in the school system yeah so thanks for the question i think that as

[02:27:21] we think about our at-risk students part of this is really focused on our our marketing and how we're going to really push this information out as we look at our students who have historically not had access to some of our dual enrollment courses our ap courses or our academy so as we look at our students with disabilities as we look at our english language learners we learn to look at our students of a lower socioeconomic status and so really making sure that we do a really good job of getting this information out to each and every one of those communities that were really clear about this is for you that you can do this that we want you as a part of this this process to consider for this Academy so that's

[02:28:01] really what it's focused on we have we're very diverse in Loudoun County and we have a lot of those students here and so just want to make sure they really focus those efforts so that and personalize them so that each of those students and families understand this is for you this is not just for somebody that you're high, you're straight A kids, your kids are in all AP classes, your kids that are going to some of your magnet schools already, but really focus on each and every one of our kids so they know that this academy could be for you.

[02:28:28] You could see yourself here. Thank you very much for sharing that. And I do want to say that I really appreciated the way that you framed the use of the lottery system within this proposal.

[02:28:45] I thought that that was very clear to me that you have a real commitment to trying to go out and capture a large pool of students that potentially, and again, I think you may have to use the lottery for this based on the quality of program that you've built out in this.

[02:29:04] And I just want to thank the staff in Loudon as I have in other divisions, as well as at the higher education level for putting this together in the way that you have. Thank you, Dr. Mariam. um i have two questions um the first is around sustainability uh you know having to raise 840 000 a year quite a hefty number um i think one of the things i would like to see are letters of financial commitment or letters of support um your application unlike in contrast to the one that we just considered does not include that i think that would enhance your application it would be

[02:29:43] something that we would want to see um going forward uh you mentioned a couple but if we'd like to see a letter um i do want to ask loud a question though relative to this when we've considered other lab school applications we do see a local contribution in this application there's a zero for local contribution and i don't mean to put you on the spot unfortunately your superintendent's not there or your school board member um but could you please speak to the

[02:30:20] division's support and engagement in this work and your enduring commitment to it as well because we are our interest is to ensure that if the student enrolls that they can complete and finish yeah so um in terms of our loudons contributions as we've partnered with george mason and nova and looked at the the staffing that are needed for for this um this lab school and the time we we have dedicated some of the staff and time that we have existing staff that we have to contribute to this project um we've already spent a good amount of time with the george mason folks and so we

[02:30:57] envision we have a number of roles that we've built into this that we have in loudon county that we would envision contributing to um to the access academy and being a part of that so that's one of the big pieces that we did we might not have explicitly stated but it's existing positions and existing resources that we already have in loud county who would dedicate to this okay um so like in the last application there was a local contribution so will there be any financial

[02:31:30] support directly provided from laden county or is it just in kind support from staffing i think in the future we could definitely consider that i think considering where we were in the time in terms of the timeline with our budget season and and where things are it was not something we were able to add in terms of a a budget ask because it would definitely be a part of our budget process but we could definitely see that as a part of the future budget process thank you for clarifying i do have one more question which uh for those who know me won't be any surprise talk to me a little bit about school meals uh in the application i noted that they'll have lunch at the program there

[02:32:08] was something about meals access being added to the card like 20 meals but really this one's more for loud since you're kind of pushing in some of the support will students have access to breakfast and lunch every day in the program and how and who was responsible for that yes as we've talked about that. We've worked with our school nutrition team about how we could bring in breakfast and lunch meals each and every day in terms of where they are at the Loudon Nova campus that is close to several of our school sites. And so how we would prepare meals and bring those in. And then we've also, as you kind of mentioned, worked with George Mason on what that could look like

[02:32:48] at the Fuse Center and some other options as we plan this out over the next year. But our initial plan has been from our nutrition team to bring in breakfast and lunch to all of our students that might want it at the Loud and Nova campus there. It's similar. We do this already for some of our other programs already, so it's not something that would be new to us or would cause any challenges for us. Okay. I'm just going to capture what I think I've heard from myself, Dr. Moran. I think that the committee would be looking for additional information on your sustainability funding plan,

[02:33:26] which may include more of a commitment from both Loudoun County, as well as letters of financial support or commitment from some of your funders, grant opportunities, some of the things that you've enumerated here today. We would be looking for more information on the academic and guidance strategies to ensure that the programs, as you have outlined, are open to all students, not just quote, at-risk students. And I would certainly want to see more particulars about how school

[02:34:03] meals will be delivered to ensure accessibility again for all students. I think that captures the deliberation. Mr. Rotherham, is there something you want to add to that? Well, I just want to make sure we're clear. Like, obviously, schools need to be open to all students. That's part of the statute here and what we're doing. But I want to make sure we don't discourage, and I don't think that's anyone's intent, because I just clear that schools that want to seek out kids who have been underserved by the traditional system or by opportunities that are currently available to them, and like, you know, extra efforts to make sure we're reaching those kids and making sure

[02:34:39] they're aware of the opportunities and so forth are fantastic. The actual admissions process needs to be open to all kids. Obviously, we need to be sensitive to some of the issues that Dr. Moran raised earlier because it can it can go the other way i just want to make sure we don't send any signal to any of these schools that we in any way want to discourage buying kids who are furthest from opportunity and bring them to opportunity that is absolutely that is absolutely fantastic i'm a more comfortable on the uh sustainability point just because i think um given the type of school this is where it's located the fact that george mason uh is is is behind it and just given

[02:35:18] their profile uh in in the community i'm i'm not i'm not overly concerned but if we want to make sure we get some clarification on that that seems fine i think we do mr rotham and um you know it i would if i might yes just note that i appreciated seeing in there that there are ongoing roundtables and you uh um delineated some of the organizations um uh big corps that you're working with google Amazon, World Services, Microsoft, Northrop Grumman, among others, that I would love to see

[02:35:55] those folks stepping up and putting a letter of commitment with your application to the state board that says we are, similarly to what the Southwest Virginia folks have, we are fully standing behind a commitment to this lab school and see the value with it. So it sounds like you already have those relationships. I know you do from some of the work that's already occurred to build partnerships in Northern Virginia. You have access to something that a lot of the state does

[02:36:27] not, and that is an incredible sector of big for-profits. Thank you. And also just two great institutions, again, Loudoun County and George Mason. I mean, I feel pretty confident about uh the the the capital of all kinds that will be behind this okay uh so i think dr armstrong has captured that i'll attempt to capture in the motion but is there a motion to approve george mason application on first and final review contingent the following areas are addressed

[02:37:06] by the applicant to conform with state law prior to the deliberation by the state board in the following areas further information on your sustainability plan to achieve the eight and forty thousand dollars a year that must be raised including further details on local contributions letters of financial support or commitment three additional detail on strategies to ensure that the school the program is open to all students and four additional information on school meals have i missed anything in that motion oh and i'm sorry dr moran also indicated

[02:37:41] as part of those letters of support specifically letters of support from google such as google Amazon, Microsoft, or Northrop Grumman, which are mentioned in your remarks as being your partners. I'm sorry, could you repeat that last one?

[02:38:02] Such as Google. The ones that George Mason mentioned, I believe, were Google, Amazon, Microsoft, and Northrop Grumman. Did I get that right? In the presentation, I mentioned Google specifically.

[02:38:19] Okay. Yeah, and those were all mentioned in the actual application as being folks that you're keeping updated and that you see as having a real commitment to supporting this up okay so that would be the motion um we would then post the application for 10-day public comment period and forward the committee's recommendation the report for consideration to virginia board of education for the april business meeting that's the motion is there a second so someone make that motion please and then just say yeah that's the motion and some so moved thank you mr rotherham is there

[02:38:59] a second second second from dr moran all those in favor please signify by saying aye aye aye aye i have two eyes so far aye aye mr rotherham where are you i'm sorry i thought i voted initially okay it's by amendment aye sorry i thought i thought that was reported to the poll any and the opposed vote nay all right well the chair had voted aye so that passes unanimously thank you very much thank you for your deliberation and your attendance of participation in the

[02:39:39] committee meeting today all right it's a little easier sometimes when we do these in person um we hear the eyes uh but we're now going to move on to item uh g right before i do that i want to say on behalf of the committee i direct the staff to post the george mason application for the attended public comment period in accordance with the standing committee's procedures and the file any comments received for review to be included in the reports to be delivered to the virginia board of education in consideration of george mason's application at their april business meeting at this time we'll proceed with item g which is first and final review of the college partnership laboratory school application from roanoke college

[02:40:14] dr armstrong has already presented this item so at this time we will hear from dr lisa stoneman associate professor of education and department chair of education at roanoke college as well as heather johnson director of academic grants and foundations at roanoke college and they will introduce the guests that are with them today welcome and thank you for being with us thank you thank you i'm going to share my screen all right we actually have um quite a few people who

[02:40:46] going to be joining us for our presentation so they're going to each introduce themselves at the time of their speaking we're going to start with dr natasha watts who's our executive director hi everybody so i'm natasha watts executive director of explorer c i'm not sure why we're getting so much feedback but we're really excited to be here today and heather sorry um so one thing i'm actually

[02:41:23] going to kind of move space to make sure it's not me whoever's presenting maybe that should be the only person with their unmute and everyone else will go on mute and we'll see if that helps yeah awesome let's see if this better perfect so um explored rc is really meant to be an immersive on-campus experience for 10th to 12th grade students um we work diligently to ensure that this program develops critical thinking skills and also helps build bridges to the workforce needs of the commonwealth um it's for darcy really aims to kind of develop the whole student not just

[02:42:00] the parts of the student. Our capstone course is going to be something we measure throughout the experience of the students there through portfolio assessment and sort of it's a unique opportunity because we really want students to be invested in learning in their communities and we're kind of aiming to shape their future not just prepare them for it. So I've said before I'm the chair of the education department at Roanoke so our pre-service teachers are really looking forward to working as peer mentors to help explore at RC students acclimate to the college community.

[02:42:36] our new master of education as well as our established annual summer education conference situates us well to offer professional development to our own faculty and previous pre-service teachers but also to the k-12 arena in our area and this is uh saisha sherry shell she's one of our students is actually going to be in our fall cohort i met with her earlier this week and i just captured a few quotes about what she's most excited about what she's looking forward to and And as you can tell, she's very much looking forward to being on campus and being integrated into that life.

[02:43:10] She's hoping to go work in the medical field one day, and she's currently going to take crime and chemistry in the fall. And she is a multi-instrumental artist. So I think that's just a little good note about her. She's just one of the fantastic students that we've already spoken with who are interested in our pipeline.

[02:43:28] So we also wanted to be very diligent in making it clear why we developed our pathways the way we did. You'll see on one side the need and the other side is the largest employers we have in Region 6. which is where Roanoke College sits. Healthcare is the largest in our area, but we know there's lots of teacher shortages.

[02:43:45] There's STEM and healthcare is the largest in our region, and communication skills is one of the things that's noted across the board that is needed in the workforce today. That leads us to our Explore at RC's pathways.

[02:44:04] These line directly with the work needs of our region, but they also offer students the variety of courses that will engage them in pursuit of a higher ed degree. Faculty teaching these courses have completed extensive professional development in order to closely address the needs of a dual enrollment student population.

[02:44:22] The orientation sessions at the beginning of each year and ongoing student support network of mentors and academic coaches are set to ensure that all students succeed. And this is an example of two of our fall students, and they each have separate pathways, but students will take transportation from their school and or rider vans to campus.

[02:44:44] And then they'll spend half a day with us and then they'll go back to their school. They are expected to eat lunch and breakfast at their home base, but we will have preloaded cards and access to snacks. We also are working to have a dedicated space in our student success center for them so that they have a place to land and they will have lockers and needs.

[02:45:00] We are in talk with several other school districts and we are scaling that quickly. The vans are one of those items that we immediately noted when we started talking to these other districts that they needed help with transportation. And so we were trying to move quickly and agilely to do that. Hi, my name is Jesse Griffin, Director of Civic Engagement.

[02:45:22] I'll be working with the capstone portion of our lab school program. For this course, students will meet twice a week. And one day of that week, they'll be in the classroom discerning their sense of purpose as they're thinking about transitioning from high school their senior year to their college years.

[02:45:38] And then one day of the week, we'll be in the field working three hours each week with one of our 15 community partners. These partners, many of those we've worked with for over 20 years, they work in the fields of health care, housing, food security, and educational programs. The capstone will culminate with an alternative spring break experience where students will go down to rural southwest Virginia and

work in housing assistance programs along with local community members. I think it'll be a neat experience for all of those students. Hi, my name is Jennifer Dean. I'm the assistant superintendent here in Salem City Schools. We're really excited to deepen our partnership with Roanoke College

[02:46:17] at explore at rc and expands our opportunities for college credit to a larger pool of our students a division of our size really relies on these partnerships to give us more access and the workforce connection is also one of our own strategic goals that we have here during this planning grant we really have enjoyed that the really close partnership to be able to do selection of courses and mapping schedules transportation and a lot of other the key details to make it possible. Good afternoon. I'm Kathy Wolf. I'm the Vice President for Academic Affairs

[02:46:56] here at Roanoke College. I just wanted to speak to the fact that Explore at RC is part of a broader strategy at the college to expand college access and affordability for students in our region. And we want to provide them with relevant and work-based learning opportunities that are grounded in a broad education. And we want to encourage a lot more of these well-educated graduates to remain here and continue to enrich our community and Roanoke College has been developing a lot more partnerships with community colleges and graduate programs in our area

[02:47:31] to create more college to career pipelines that will benefit students in the commonwealth and Explore at RC is part of that larger vision and so college leadership is highly supportive of this initiative. Hi I'm Dave Taylor I'm the assistant VP for academic operations and I just to say it's been great working with lisa heather and natasha on our enrollment and budget numbers uh so to give you a quick rundown here we expect about 40 students in the first year 75 year two and then uh slowly growing towards 150 sustainable in year five and beyond um we do this reaching

[02:48:08] sustainability by building in our actual expected you know cost for instruction for explored rc students so that lab school students at rona college have that rich rona college experience with the added support and benefits that prepared them for college after high school hopefully at rona college but wherever they may end up for example year one these 40 explored rc students taking two courses in the fall two in the spring that's about 160 seats and courses so rather than trying to you know look at tuition dollars and all sorts of things there rather this you know 160 students that's about eight to nine additional courses per year we staff those and And that's the instructional costs we put in for our budget.

[02:48:47] We first and second year courses regularly run at or near capacity. So these are needed costs, but also it lets us allocate professional development dollars, travel dollars for our faculty that opt in, apply to be a part of Explored RC so that sustainability doesn't become just part of a financial thing, but also part of the culture at Roanoke College.

[02:49:12] Sorry, I couldn't figure out how to unmute myself while I was also screen sharing. i'm heather johnson director of grants at roanoke college and we are so excited about the new students we're going to be able to serve through explored rc and we are deeply committed to making sure that this is financially sustainable and viable in the long term for roanoke college part of the way we're approaching sustainability is as dave already mentioned scaling our enrollment targets to meet the size and capacity of our small institution to ensure that we can actually

[02:49:47] sustain this and we built our budget in a way that brings ExploreNRC into who we are already so that there's a level of sustainability built into just making sure this is part of what we regularly do. We are requesting 3.572 million from the VDOE for our operations and that also includes the 1 million dollars

in the startup grants per pupil costs each year average between six and seven thousand and by year five the program will be self-sustaining through a variety of

[02:50:19] revenue sources including local cost share private and federal funds and contributions from roanoke college and also tuition dollars that we're going to eventually see from students that i'll explain in a second we're going to go back to this slide and look at the outside funding one thing that we think is unique about our program is that we're going to start fundraising right away so that there's an on-ramp and a gradual progression towards that sustainability in year five we will be seeking private and federal grants and our numbers here are based on the institution's investment in grant consultants in year one and two and our current track record with grants so those numbers are not numbers that we just picked out of thin air but they're based

[02:50:59] on our current track record and based on the types of funders that we're going to be pursuing we also are going to be working on a one million dollar endowment campaign for explore at rc that aligns with a larger endowment campaign for the whole institution and that will start to return five percent or fifty thousand dollars in revenue by year four we're going to run a creative sponsor and explorer initiative with local individuals businesses and industry partners and then a cost share will start in year five with local participating school districts at 43 dollars per credit also based on current local yield rates through our admissions office we anticipate

[02:51:38] that about 20 percent of the students who participate in explored rc will end up matriculating as full Roanoke College students. So we do anticipate a small annual source of revenue through commuter student tuition and fees as a result of this program and the marketing of this program in the area. And finally, we'll regularly assess expenses and adjust our budget accordingly to ensure optimal allocation of resources. Well, thank you guys so much. That's kind of what we have today. We're ready for questions. Thank you. Is there anyone else that you have from your team or area that you want to that would like to make a remark to the

[02:52:16] committee today i just want to think we incorporated everyone into our presentation so artful i like it okay great here we go okay um let's go to i believe mr bailey is going to have to leave so i'm going to go to him first and see if you have any questions or comments uh no no questions impressed um by the um uh the work and the effort you put into it because i wish i could go to a school like this um the uh just a question joan for you what is the process since i have to jump now unfortunately because i have this hard stop what is the process going forward for this application

[02:52:52] but then also the the other ones that we have in the pipeline do we schedule those for a vote next week we would just keep going through because we have quorum just like we have at other committee meetings yep we don't madam president have quorums i have to drop as well um i'm sort of pushing back as much as i can but we are going to have we're going to run into a quorum problem we can try to get through rona and and presentation i suspect the bill you probably have a commitment at five o'clock too now all right mr hansen we can't hear you i can keep going it's important to get these

[02:53:30] done can you hear me yeah again thank you so uh so i guess mr bailey mr rotham will lose it to you and uh bill with bill and dr moran and myself will still maintain form so we can continue okay fantastic okay thank you gentlemen thank you okay um let's let's see uh dr moran or mr hansen if they have questions for you relative to your application i know i have a couple myself

[02:54:07] um but mr hansen do you have any questions no just again very much appreciate the quality work thank you dr moran i i want to bring jennifer and jennifer dean and assistant superintendent in uh Salem City and I'm looking to see where the Roanoke folks are um at the yeah and also at the the school level um one of the questions I have Jennifer is when I look at the courses

[02:54:43] that are specified in the the course list that will be taught at Roanoke College I know that there's a statement in the actual application that there will be SOL alignment one of the questions that i have is that given that the content of some of those courses does not look like necessarily um traditional sol coursework um that high school students participate in what's the process of faculty working through an alignment focus to be sure that kids are getting

[02:55:22] what they need in order because they will still be required to take sol test in target areas correct so just wondering how how you're all working together to be sure that that alignment occurs so that kids are not at risk of potentially not hitting the mark on an sol test well big kudos to renal college for this too because um they've really worked with us um they've sat with um the people at the high school to go through competencies of what is in that course along with

[02:55:55] the competencies that are required for SOL courses and mapped those together to make sure that we don't miss out and then and then counseled students to make sure that we are making the right decision to help students be successful when they're required to take an SOL test in addition to this.

[02:56:18] It's just one of the realities of our kids lives and our staff's loss and wanting to just be sure that I love some of the sort of differentiated content that appears to be built out from an inquiry process.

[02:56:34] And some of these courses would certainly want to see that that alignment is very explicit. So that was one of my... Yeah, and they've done a really nice job of thinking through it with us and really looking at what does this course have? What does this course have and how do they match up?

[02:56:52] I can add to that, Jennifer, just to say this is part of the professional development for Rona College faculty is to include and make sure that this SOL alignment is there, but also Lisa Stoneman is chair of our education department, and it's a nice alignment here where we have the people in the right place to be able to pivot. If SOLs change, we know that information. Lisa's aware of that, and it's built into our process. And they are changing, so as those of us on the education PK-12 side know. The other question that I had was in relationship

[02:57:26] to the professional development of both faculty from both sides of the equation that are going to be working together and how that's going to happen and what you see as some of the target areas for that if you've delineated that to date.

[02:57:48] But also, we really have been very focused on something that you said, which is how do we build a pipeline of young people to see the profession of teaching as something that they want to pursue?

[02:58:04] And you talked about peer support. Are there ways that your teacher candidates that are in waiting are going to actually be immersed in this? So they're learning the strategies that you have embedded, which are great strategies. And I love the portfolio concept that you've built out in this as well.

[02:58:24] Thank you. We appreciate that. We've worked pretty hard on that end of it. We see our pre-service teachers gaining from this as much as the dual enrollment students do in a true lab school kind of

environment where they are able to go in and meet with students on a regular basis, regular schedule, along with their academic coach.

[02:58:44] So the academic coach and the peer mentor are two different folks. Our peer mentors are students themselves. They're not expected to be tutors, but they are expected to open up the college life to these new students and figure out how to navigate, for instance, a relationship with your professor.

[02:59:03] How do you communicate with your professor in a constructive way? What are questions that you can ask in class? How do you question? How do you form those kinds of things without feeling like you're interrupting the professor? Those kinds of things are how we're going to start that, but our pre-service teachers will lean more heavily into helping coordinate the relationship between the professors who are teaching the course, because they're teaching a lot of other courses as well, and may not even know that this student needs help, but that the peer mentor is a bridge to help connect the student with the person that will most likely help them.

[02:59:41] in the best possible way. And I think that's a great way for our pre-service teachers to start learning when to step in, how to integrate, you know, assessing basically the learning process is breaking down. Where do they think it's breaking down and how can they interact to help it?

[02:59:58] - And if I could jump in just for a moment, when we put out a call to our faculty at Roanoke College to see who wanted to participate in this program, we were inundated. We had far more faculty interested in teaching courses at explorenrc than we have room for as we start. So we've got a pipeline of wonderful faculty who are interested in this as well. And I think from the professional development side, we're seeing it really holistically. Like we're going to share, the students are going to share, the teachers are going to, we're going to each be teaching each other very directed things. The portfolio assessment is part of that, presenting that, looking at that, working through that, picking off professional

[03:00:37] developments that really work through that. And it's about the student and about their experience and how we can make that progressively better as they go along. So when we think about professional development, I think we echo that in our application. It's really our faculty have things to learn from the teachers.

[03:00:52] We all have things to learn from the students. You know, our pre-service teachers have things to teach us as well about their experience and what's happening. And so those are kind of the professional developments we are going to create and are in motion already. Because teaching, I don't know to what extent that Roanoke College faculty embrace an inquiry approach in their classrooms, but I do know that teaching from an inquiry model is very different than what the traditional models look like in most college and university settings.

[03:01:24] So with a group of kids that you are trying to nurture into the skill sets that you've identified. I think it's a nice match. But I also know that it demands a skillfulness that doesn't always necessarily exist in either public school faculty or higher ed. We are quite fortunate in that our entire general education curriculum is built on an inquiry model. So there are a number of faculty that are already used to teaching in that format. So we were very lucky in that. And I think it's why we had such a good response to the request to come and teach this new group.

[03:02:07] Ms. Rotherham, I see you still here. Do you have any comments or questions on this one? I don't. I have to drop it. I wanted to get through this agenda item. Okay. All right. I have a couple questions.

So, having to raise $1.2 million a year is a pretty sizable amount of money. I think one of the biggest fundraising objectives of any application that we have received almost not quite but really close um in your application you reference an nsf

[03:02:42] grant in the amount of half a million dollars a year have you applied for that grant so we're currently working with a grant consulting company that um is helping us build out our strategy for years years three four and five um and they're all focused on six seven figure grants and so they've identified already about five opportunities for us to start applying for but it is a little bit tricky with the timing of it so we don't we have not applied for those yet but we have identified probably about five federal opportunities that we're going to be applying for and then several

[03:03:20] private foundations that we're going to be applying to as well and one of those nsf grants is to take students studying hard sciences and help them get certified to teach and so that's one area that we've already started talking and drafting and looking at it but the timing of of the application is just not in line with the timing of this meeting but that is one that we had a discussion with the grant consultants about particularly but you have not applied for that grant even though it's listed in your sustainability chart as a funding source that's correct okay and

[03:03:57] you also list as funding sources the teagle foundation macarthur kellogg and arthur do you have funds from those foundations and letters of support we do not those are all part of the funding strategy that we're working towards for year five but since that's 2029 2030 we weren't sure when the timing was to get those letters of support if that's something that's needed then we can start working towards getting those but we do not have applications out yet i think it's also probably a challenge until you've got the approval in hand to be doing what you're doing

[03:04:36] to go forth so i think that's been a little bit challenging cart before the horse so let's get this approved and get you on your way i concur i mean look speaking as a state board member on this like i want to see i get very concerned if i see an application that has no attention to sustainability and no for forethought but these out year things a lot can happen um i mean you could have grants in and then issues could come up in the economy and so forth i just think we need to make sure that there's attention and thought to this but we can't we're not none of us have a crystal ball on what the fundraising climate is going to be like and i'm satisfied you all have a plan that is

[03:05:15] thoughtful and you've given attention to this issue of of sustainability and the college has already invested in these grant consultants and we've already started working with them so that is one thing the college is already doing to ensure that we can get there so it's we're not just doing it alone perfect madam chair i apologize if i may um roanoke you all also do have an agreement with salem city as part of your sustainability as well correct is there a funding stream from salem city schools as well yes we oh go ahead jennifer i see you unmuted go ahead heather uh we've discussed

[03:05:55] the local cost share um we don't we did not have that in our mou because we developed the mou before we um so if we needed to adopt adopt the uh the mou to make sure that that's explicitly stated we can probably do that um yeah that would add some strength to that i think yes i think we would like to see that um you also mentioned that you're working on an endowment where are you in your fundraising for that endowment we're working our um our entire endowment for the entire school right now is about 143 million dollars and our goal one of our strategic initiatives for the

[03:06:35] entire school is to triple the endowment over the next 10 years so we're in the quiet phase of a campaign right now for that endowment campaign and so we're working with the advancement team to identify which are the donors that we can go after for explore at rc and which ones are going to be pursued for other endowment initiatives so that's we're currently currently in the quiet phase of that so we have not approached any donors yet but we're building out a pipeline and building out a prospect list with the Advancement Office. Thank you. So I'm a little

[03:07:09] confused. When I look at your sustainability chart that was provided, you're listing foundation funds from Teagle, MacArthur, Kellogg, Arthur, and you're listing an NSF Department of Education or Department of Energy grant, but yet you haven't applied for these and you don't have any letters of commitment or support from any of these organizations. I believe what we're trying to insinuate there was that those were the sources that we were going to be going after.

[03:07:44] If we need to remove those completely, then that's fine. But we wanted to show some substance to where those sources were that we are pursuing. I don't know if there's anyone else who wants to jump in on that. It's a little bit of a chicken or egg question. It's kind of hard to go to the funders and ask for the letter of support before we have approval from the state.

[03:08:07] well it hasn't quite been for some of our other applicants so i don't think everybody's the same matter and i think that mr hampson please uh let me finish my questions my line of remark on this one because we have seen letters of support from other foundations we have seen grant we have seen other items where there is a better plan of financial commitment and support and that was transparent the suggestion that you have nsf funds when you don't have nsf funds or the suggestion that you have foundation funds when you don't have foundation funds in your sustainability plan

[03:08:46] is concerning to me i don't think there's i don't think they're saying i'll let them speak for themselves i don't think they let them speak for themselves this is my line of questioning gentlemen i know it's upsetting and disappointing to you that i'm raising it's not upsetting or it's also a few million dollars and they don't have a plan to do so yet i think it's disrespectful frankly to some hard-working educators in the state i don't think they implied that and to have them come in here and then sort of that they're somehow misrepresenting i think is is inappropriate and over the line they've worked hard on this we should ask questions we should

[03:09:22] do our diligence but madam chair to suggest that that they're that they're somehow you know cloak and dagger with us i think i think is over the line but i'll let them i'll let them speak for themselves well i'm just trying to ascertain what they have and where they are in their process one of the requirements before the standing committee is to assess whether or not there is a sustainable funding plan it doesn't mean that they have to have all of it i mean when we think about emory and henry for example they have a good portion of it what i'm trying to ascertain because of the way

[03:10:00] that the chart has been put together and i appreciate that maybe you know maybe roano didn't put that chart together or maybe they did put that chart together because i know that there are others assisting in the development of those charts what i would like to see is transparency and clarity if it is ambition to apply for a grant i think that should be clearly stated i don't think it should be included in the chart because it looks like a commitment when in fact it is not um i'd like to speak please yeah that'd be great i'd like to speak to that intent it was

[03:10:36] certainly not our intent to not be transparent but to put in there and in the brackets we did per year and i'll let um heather and natasha also speak to this because we've worked on it together for a number of weeks here in this particular way that we are directly looking for funding sources spread out over time that we are most likely to get early on midpoint and later on it takes a while to gain an endowment and then have it start to return for you so you can't build that in the first year but you certainly can aspire to build that in the fifth year however we have been very

[03:11:13] intentional about looking at the kinds of services we're offering at the kinds of courses we're teaching at the kind of pathways we have that are funded by entities such as the ones we've listed and that is our intent to come up with a verifiable funding source pool where we can spend our time with our grant consultants with our our board are all the folks that help us fundraise at rena college to target the most likely fruit let me ask one follow-up question

[03:11:50] on that. If you weren't able, and this is maybe, maybe this is another way to come at this. If you weren't able to raise those funds in year five to the totality of $1.2 million, is Roanoke College going to, through your endowment or other resources, fill in the difference so that the program could continue? I can let Dave Taylor speak to some of this because he's our numbers guy.

[03:12:21] But I can say we would certainly want students to be able to complete the program. And the college is putting a great deal of in-kind support in. So we are providing the faculty and staff, classroom and lab space, academic support coaches, learning common space for the students, some transportation, et cetera.

[03:12:42] So I think we could think about, you know, are there some nice-to-haves that aren't just essentials that we could think about paring back if we had to? certainly. We're the kind of college that needs to think about those questions all the time, frankly, given the state of higher ed these days. But we aspire to do this kind of fundraising, and I am confident that we will be able to get there. I feel like, look, Eisenhower said about war plans. They're great until you make first contact, and I think that's true with fundraising

[03:13:16] plans this seems thoughtful in terms of you know known unknowns four or five years from now but we can't know those and that seems like a very difficult uh a difficult standard speaking for myself as one board member I'm comfortable that there is a there is sufficient foresight in the plan here accounting for the fact that we you know we can't predict the future I agree and I think the key word is plan and I commend you and also just based on your track record with your endowment than your other fundraising for other projects.

[03:13:50] I think that I'm very, very comfortable in understanding the quality of the school and the things that you've done that should be replicable. And so I just commend you again.

[03:14:10] - One of the things that we received from other applicants has been a letter of support from the institution assuring that should the funds not be potentially raised, that they would provide ongoing support. And here's why I am pressing on this.

[03:14:27] I mean, I sense sensitivity from the other committee members. It's a really important point for me personally. It's one that I've heard from others in the state, including Secretary Gadara, that we really wanna ensure that there is sustainable funding and a commitment.

[03:14:43] And there's kind of two reasons for it. Well, actually there's three. Let's go with the first obvious one. You know, when I'm betting on children's future, I'm not a gambler. I don't like to bet on the cum. like to know that that's a sure thing. A sure thing can be provided by having a letter of support from the institution. When we originally had lab schools back in the 80s and 90s and the economy started to decline, we saw lab schools that were hosted by our education institutions close.

[03:15:08] We also saw a lot of, we lost a lot of R&D research within the public education space. I'm asking that hard question now to say, "Hey, let's learn from the past and let's not do that again so you can get a letter from your institution i think that was when we've seen that from some of our other four-year institutions i want to like i'm not treating you for like other four-year institutions have said look we're going to do our absolute best we're going to do our diligence but if you know circumstances change and we don't get the msf grant or we don't get this kind of thing we are in this for students and we're going to continue to do it and certainly to dr wolf your

[03:15:45] point if it means that we need to adjust the program or maybe not have as many students so be it but we will at least at a minimum continue with those that are in it um and maybe not take more but i think you understand where i'm going and i would echo along with that that um anytime that you undergo trying to stand up a program that is innovative it's going to serve it's you know not really a micro school but it's a small alt school environment it's going to cost more oftentimes to be able to serve per pupil than you do in your big comprehensives. One of the things

[03:16:23] that I think in addition to Roanoke College, and I did go back and reread the letter from the president in which, you know, there is a real clear statement of commitment to this program as well as from the K-12, the PK-12 folks. I think that one of the things that does have to happen for every one of these lab schools, because there is no guarantee that the state of Virginia is going to, the Commonwealth is going to fill in the gaps for these programs, that if you think they're good, and you're willing to stand behind them, you're going to have to be prepared to run

[03:16:58] them in spite of what may or may not materialize from foundations, philanthropics, NSF, the commonwealth and so i think that's really what you're trying to get to uh chair wadiska is how do we make sure that there is a commitment to sustainability that's not contingent upon we hope that nsf will come through with money etc but we're willing to to own this and move it forward that's just i think my perspective on it so you know and that's really the the full throttle for

[03:17:38] the school divisions and the university to be able to or the college to be able to do that so it's just something to think about as we get ready to to potentially take a vote to move this one forward my second reason for asking um is you know there it doesn't appear that there will be i'll call it new money more money for for lab schools on a going forward basis in the current

[03:18:06] context and so um having plan b is important okay so if you can so i think what i'm hearing i'm dr moran your questions about academics those involve changes to applications otherwise i perceive that this is a bit like the george mason application and i've made some notation here it looks i'm just going to double check did you have any academic changes you need made no i felt very comfortable with responses to my questions okay great thank you so at this time then it would be

[03:18:46] a motion to approve grono college on first and final contingent of the following areas including that the applicant would provide a more detailed financial plan to raise 1.2 million dollars per year additional letters of financial support or commitment either from foundations or federal opportunities or

and or a letter of support from the institution for ongoing and enjoying support all things that sound profitable from our conversation um and this would be done to

[03:19:18] conform with state law prior to the deliberation by the state board of education that would be the motion is that so moved and is the rest so moved thank you mr rochman is there a second second Dr. Moran, all those in favor, please signify by saying aye. I see a thumbs up from Bill.

[03:19:46] I see a thumbs up from Mr. Rotherham, Dr. Moran, share your voice. You guys are making me work for it today. The motion unanimously passes and you're all set. So at this time, I direct on behalf of the committee, I direct the staff to post the Roanoke College application for attending a public comment period in accordance with the standing committee's procedures and compile any comments receive a review to be included in the report to be delivered to the virginia board of education and consideration of roanoke's application at their april business meeting okay let's proceed

[03:20:23] to item h which madam chair i have to excuse i have to excuse myself roanoke team thank you so much roanoke salen team thank you thank you thank you guys okay all right we're still going strong all right so now this time we're going to go to item h which is the first and final review of the College Partnership Laboratory application from Paul DeCamp Community College. The committee will hear from Dr. Cory McRae, President of the Paul DeCamp Community College, and Dr. Adkins Braddy, Braddy, excuse me, Vice President of Academic and Student Development from Paul DeCamp Community

[03:21:00] College, followed by any other special guests that we have from this community and this lab school application. Well, good afternoon, good evening, Madam Chair, and I want to, My name is Cory McCray. I'm the president of Pauly Camp Community College. I want to extend my appreciation to the committee for hearing this proposal this evening. I really appreciate you all and the deliverance that's happening as you take on this very important matter of lab schools. I really appreciate the work that you all are doing. We're very excited to propose

[03:21:39] to you all tonight are our Maritime Trades Academy. We're excited for a couple of reasons. First, this academy will allow students or provide students the opportunity to engage early in high school in career pathways that will be sustainable, life sustainable for them upon completion of high school. Secondly, it is very important because we are responding to a workforce demand with the

[03:22:14] ship repair and ship building industry. This is a matter of national defense. As you all may know, the Navy is going to be going to more than 300 ships in an effort to make certain that we have a sustainable national defense and so we think this is this is really important work and it's really a great opportunity for our students in olive white county and beyond in our service region to engage in a career pathway that directly involves them with the opportunity for employment that is life sustainable and in so many cases will be

[03:22:54] will change the trajectory of their lives once they're once they are enrolled in this academy my my colleague the vice president for uh the vice president and the chief academic officer is going to talk through a lot of the presentation but i am uh i want to up front just address the fact that our partners here are all in the newport new shipyard and huntington angles are on the call they have been with us since the day one that we started this conversation.

[03:23:31] Olive White Public Schools, the same. We have been in boardrooms and in discussion for months on end talking about this, making certain that this is going to yield a great benefit for our students

as well as the workforce demand and the industry in the Hampton Roads area. If you didn't know the shipyard is the largest industrial employer in the state of Virginia. Tens of thousands of workforce demand for students in this area. So we know this is the right thing to do.

[03:24:10] And so I'm excited for you to hear how we're going to address this workforce demand, but more importantly, make certain that our students have an opportunity that will change the trajectory of their lives and so i'll ask dr atkins brady to walk through this and at the end we're we're happy to entertain entertain questions we did lose a couple of our members who had to move on at five but we still have a a good contingency here so dr atkins brady if you would thank you dr mccray

[03:24:43] good afternoon madam chair and members of the committee as dr mccray gave us a little bit of Preview. The Isle Maritime Trades Academy, what we're calling IMTA, we anticipate that that's going to have a significant impact on students, families, community, and our maritime industrial workforce. The academy is going to prepare students for immediate employment in high-demand skilled trades with our regional maritime employers, and those career pathways are going to provide both a family-sustaining income and opportunities for advancement through further

[03:25:19] education and training after high school. Our program model is a two-year cohort model enrolling high school juniors and seniors. Students will enter the academy as juniors in one of two career pathways, maritime welding or marine electrical. At capacity, the IMTA is going to serve 80 students, that's 20 students per pathway per grade level. The curriculum consists primarily of dual enrollment credit courses in the first three semesters and trade specific workforce training in the fourth

[03:25:53] semester as well as co-curricular activities throughout the program including things like career advising mentoring industry tours job shadowing workplace readiness and interview skills in alignment with the governor's initiatives around dual enrollment students who complete our curriculum at the imta will earn at least one career study certificate multiple industry recognized credentials and an associate of applied science and technical studies degree from camp community college to say a little bit more about the pathways both welding and

[03:26:29] electrical pathways will provide foundational courses in safety and drafting or blueprint reading which falls under our drafting curriculum we will have in the welding pathway general welding and professional welding and pipe so those are two career study certificates that students will learn and then they will also participate in marine trades training pipe fitter structural fitter and marine coding and again that technical studies degree is an option at the end in the electrical pathway it is similar in this pathway students will earn a practical electrician career study

[03:27:06] certificate they will take additional electricity courses that are specific to the workplace in maritime trade so power distribution systems industrial electricity and programmable controllers then they will take participate in the marine trades training with the basic marine electrician outside machinist and sheet metal courses and again for them the aas and technical studies degree which will include for both pathways those career technical courses the general education courses

[03:27:41] that are relevant to our degree and credit for learning in the workforce training for maritime trades dr mccray spoke about our partners i just want to highlight what those partners have talked about with us and are agreeing to do in partnership with us so isla white county schools they will be providing some facilities for the welding and electrical courses they are providing faculty and subject matter experts they will be providing transportation and meals for the

[03:28:16] imta students as well as testing support student support and participation on our governing board for the imta and advisory board similarly newport news shipbuilding is providing subject matter experts individuals who can serve as mentors to the imta students and we are exploring tours job shadowing Newport News conducting mock interviews with our students and we've discussed guaranteed interviews for qualified students who successfully complete the IMTA curriculum that may be my

[03:28:53] favorite part and governing board and advisory board representation as well use me one moment while I just what I can see on my screen target population and need for this program we anticipate that our target population will be students who are interested in a career technical pathway that leads directly to employment the imta is open to all students we anticipate initial and primary student population will likely be students from isle of white county and as our partner isle of

[03:29:30] white county survey data supports the enrollment targets for the imta we also expect interest from students and districts within an adjacent to camp community college's service region maritime trades was selected to address a regional need for more trained and qualified individuals to enter the advanced manufacturing workforce including skill production manufacturing shipbuilding and repair as dr dr mcrae alluded to earlier this represents nearly 20 000 regional jobs with family sustaining earnings and a projected 10-year age out between a quarter and a third of the workforce so there

[03:30:05] is a need for this program this school newport new shipbuilding has identified welders electricians ship fitters pipe fitters marine coding and outside machinists as high need occupations for their organization. So we are meeting a very specific workforce need. And my apologies, my inter-key is no longer advancing my slides. Hey, we've all had something. You joined a popular

[03:30:42] club. I was so close. I'm going to stop share and try reloading it. Okay. Trying this one more time.

[03:31:09] Is that visible? It is. Okay, let's try it this way. So a day in the life at IMTA. IMTA is a full day curriculum students will take classes on a monday thursday tuesday friday schedule wednesdays are reserved for skills labs remediation credit recovery advising and those co-curricular activities that i mentioned so in year one juniors will complete foundational and general education courses at camps center at smithfield in morning blocks one and two students will be transported by Isle of Wight County Schools to the appropriate facility for lunch and the career technical

[03:31:49] courses in the afternoon blocks three and four. Windsor High School will host the electrical training. Smithfield High School will host the welding coursework. In year two and thereafter, in the second semester of the senior year, seniors will take their career technical courses in the morning at Camp's Workforce Trades and Innovation Center and their general education in the afternoon at Camp's Center at Smithfield. Our overall budget and sustainability plan is we have

[03:32:24] it workable year zero through year five. I want to mention specifically our strategies for sustainability. You'll notice that in year one, Camp Community College is investing $150,000 in higher education institutional support. And then in year two, we begin to receive some state funding from the FTE that's generated by the dual enrollment. So we will begin investing that portion of that state funding that's generated by the dual enrollment in the IMTA

[03:32:59] back into the school. And that increases over years two through four as we increase from 40 students in year one to 80 students in year two. And that FTE allocation from the state is generated on a

three-year rolling average. So that's the reason we can increase and then sustain at the 176,000. We will also be putting back into the operation of the school the tuition that we receive through the fast forward funding. So this is what will support those students in the IMTA

[03:33:34] in their second semester of their senior year that are taking the maritime trades training at the Workforce Trades and Innovation Center. We are also committing by year five, $50,000 from our equipment trust fund. We know that this is an equipment intensive endeavor, and so we will need to repair, replace, and purchase equipment. We do intend to, through expanded partnerships and fundraising, make up the balance by year five. Camp Community College has an extensive and

[03:34:11] successful record of fundraising for programs and services at the college. We are requesting the $7,000 per student per year in year one, and then you'll see a decrease in that in years two and year three as we work our way to zero. Thank you. I would invite others that you have from your community or that are working in partnership with your application to feel free to address the committee at this time. And Madam Chair, I'm sorry, Madam Chair, the superintendent and the

[03:34:48] school board chairman from Olive White had to leave because they had a school board meeting tonight. So Dr. Marsha Kale has been, again, significantly integral in this process. And so she is here to speak to Olive White's commitment around this work. Dr. Kale, if you would please do us the honors. Absolutely. Good evening, Madam Chair, members of the committee. We are very excited about this partnership. My school board chair and superintendent did ask me to emphatically share their apologies that they weren't able to stay on. Our board meeting started

[03:35:26] at five o'clock today, and so they were obligated to be there. But we have spoken not only with our school board, as well as other members of my team, but also with our board of supervisors. they are all very much in favor of this. Other partners, Hampton Roads Workforce Council, and then even our Economic Development Office, they are all also very much in support of the lab school. I think that it's going to provide our students with a really awesome and unique

[03:35:59] opportunity to earn credentials that many of them would not otherwise be able to access. One of the things that makes Isle of Wight really unique in our data is that more than 50% of our students actually do not go on to four-year universities.

[03:36:19] They are going to two-year schools or they're going directly into the job market. And so this, a program like this, a school like this, we try to steer away from program. It really is a school opportunity, gives them a unique position in that job market where they are highly skilled, highly trained, and have a resume that is proliferated with experiences that are real world, something that they're not going to get anywhere else, particularly before high school graduation.

[03:36:53] So we are really, really excited about this partnership. Dr. Cahill, thank you for joining us. I'd like to ask Mr. Bill DeColovich from Newport News Shipyard, Huntington Ingles, if he'd like to share any words. Bill, are you are you still on?

[03:37:11] Hi, this is Bill DeColovich. Thanks, Corey. I hope you all can hear me. Madam Chair and board members, thanks for your consideration of this. What we feel is an important initiative to help with our really hard challenging workforce issues that the navy is facing right now naval construction and submarine construction the navy has recognized that hampton roads is a a key component to ship

[03:37:47] building and we have seen navy investment but this just builds on programming that Newport News Shipbuilding has been involved, worked with Corey a number of years with providing subject matter expertise in various community colleges in the region.

[03:38:12] And we've also had a relationship with Isla White and serving on advisory boards there. So this lab school model is really, we're excited because it's pulling together what we view as some really strong players.

[03:38:29] to help our company. We think that this is going to be providing the exposure for maritime work earlier in students' lives, which will be useful, as well as allow a good connection with our mentors and our subject matter experts. And Dr. Atkins-Grady, our favorite part also is the hiring of hopefully 100 or so folks a year that would help our hiring targets that we project to

[03:39:08] be 3,000 to 5,000 people a year, at least for the next five years, and most likely longer. So I will certainly attest that we're excited to be engaged with both CAMP and Isle of Light in this model. And we hope that we can build this even stronger and rely upon the output joining our company. Thank you, sir, for being with us. We very much appreciate that input

[03:39:43] and feedback and your collaboration with Calde Camp and the Isle of Light School Division. President McRae, are there any other members that you would like to address the standing committee at this time? Our chief workforce officer, Dr. Tony Johnson, is also on the call.

[03:40:05] Dr. Johnson, if you have any additional words to share with the committee, that'd be great. Certainly. Thank you, Dr. McCray. I would just like to thank the standing committee for this opportunity to present on the behalf of Paul DeCamp, Olive White Public Schools, as well as Newford New Shipyard. We believe this is an innovative and unique opportunity for students who will enroll in the school that will allow them to change the trajectory of their lives and to meet the workforce demand within not just our service area, but within the state

[03:40:42] of Virginia. So we are excited about the opportunity. We thank you for hearing our presentation today and we look forward to your questions. Thank you. - And Madam Chair, I will close this part of our comments by just sharing with you.

[03:40:58] When we think about sustainability, our partnerships around this area is tried and true. We, as Bill said, we've been working with them in some capacity to build a pipeline for the shipyard for more than a decade. And we've been very successful with 90% of the students who go through the training, being employed six years and beyond, changing their lives.

[03:41:23] I will also share with you that as a testament to the commitment for sustainability, the Navy just invested $3.1 million in CAP's Workforce Trades and Innovation Center, which we broke ground last week.

[03:41:38] So we have big support in the Hampton Roads Western Tidewater area around skilled trades and specifically maritime trades from the Navy, the ship yard, and I will tell you that the Virginia Ship Repair Association, who also provided us a letter of support, has a 300-member organization that also have been our partners for more than a decade, and they're very excited. One of the members, obviously, and the biggest member is Newport News Shipyard. But there's another at least 299 shipbuilders and ship repair

[03:42:16] member organizations that's behind this effort. Thank you, President. This time I'll go to questions or comments from committee members. Mr. Hanson, I see you're unmuted. I'll go to you first, sir. Dr. McCray, thank you and to your team and just really commend you for the vision and just the need for um the students in your community and for your community so just uh thank you and um and again i just uh thank you for hanging with us uh into the evening here and um

[03:42:54] but just i don't have any questions at this time other than just thank you for uh the quality uh proposal thank you sir dr moran dr moran you're muted you're on mute pam dr moran you're muted there we go my unmute cup i'll never forget sitting in a meeting with dr frank friedman at piedmont virginia community college when he heard about the shortages of welders down in the ship

[03:43:32] building industry and immediately went to uh the mats to offer a welding program at piedmont virginia community college so we could send kids from central virginia down to the uh the tide water area so um it's it's great to see your program building out a pipeline into jobs that are jobs of the past the present and the future because the technology is certainly changing in the world of welding just as it has everywhere else um one of the questions that i had very specifically was um i know to get through the gate to a job as a welder that you're going to

[03:44:11] to have to do an apprenticeship, that is not necessarily a part of your requirements for students that they begin moving towards an apprenticeship. I was not able to kind of to unpack the application enough to really know what the status of that in terms of licensure was going to be for these programs that are pretty high-end programs in terms of skill sets and expertise that kids are going to need to develop. If I could respond and perhaps shed

[03:44:46] some light on how apprenticeships are conducted at Newport News, that on a given year, we would hire 250 welders a year. Our apprentice school would accept and start only, I'm rounding, but 30 to 40 people into their welding class, their apprentice class that would be focused

[03:45:20] on welding. So the bulk of our workforce does not come through our apprentice school. The Apprentice school only brings in roughly 200 people a year, and we're hiring 3,000 to 5,000 people a year.

[03:45:35] Now, but that doesn't preclude, and I hope that the programs that we establish will be good feeder pools for that apprentice school, and that'll be certainly a mark of a very successful outcome.

[03:45:58] Um, but indeed there's a, a, uh, majority of our people do come in entry level, uh, and not through the apprentice school. But these, these students coming out of this program will have some sort of a, I'd love to see something more explicit about the transition and support from the apprentice school to really make sure that these young people, cause that is a metric.

[03:46:27] Do these kids actually get jobs in the careers that you're setting them up to move into? And so that would be something I think perhaps could really be a good just add in with it. And it appears that while there was some question from the department in terms of compliance issues that your faculty would indeed be able to be licensed to teach, it appeared that that has been satisfied, Mr. Armstrong.

[03:46:56] Is that correct? - Yes, ma'am, Dr. Moran, that has been satisfied. We had a call about that several weeks ago, I think, with Paul DeCamp. And that's a typical question among a lot of our lab school applicants, especially one of the CTE focus.

[03:47:12] And of course, we experienced that in K-12 schools as well. But we have identified a path for CTE/Duel Enrollment Licensure for anyone who's not currently licensed as a K-12 teacher. That would then make them qualify under that statutory requirement.

[03:47:28] - Thank you. Thank you, Dr. Lyons. I have a couple questions. The first, I want to compliment you. This is exactly the intent of the lab school program is to scale, meet workforce needs, collaborate between K-12 and higher education. And when I read your application, the very first thing that came to my mind was, how can we have more students go to this program?

[03:47:59] And I want you to know that. That was the very first thing. I was like, oh, this is incredible. This is absolutely incredible. When I hear, you know, the number of individuals that are needed in this industry, understanding, just as you said, the connection to not only the economy, but national security and overall well-being, and it's compelling.

[03:48:19] I would say from my time working with some of the folks over in the aerospace field, I also know that many of the welding skills that are good for shipyards are also good for aerospace. And so there's a duality of the program. There's a lot of transferable skills.

[03:48:36] So this was incredibly exciting to me. So just to level set, this is an incredible application. The second is you were the first one to thoughtfully include some of the other programs that are available in the state from the Workforce Investment Act, such as the Fast Forward program, the tech transfer.

[03:48:55] These are exactly the types of things in terms of financial sustainability that we're looking for, which is an amalgamation of other resources that are available, either federal or state grants, that can be brought together into a cohesive and intentional program.

[03:49:11] And when I read about that, I just want you to, again, like my compliments to you. So I just have a couple of ticky tacky items that I found going through your application. And if we had an opportunity to be more deliberative, these things would have come up probably through a site visit or some other kind of conversation.

[03:49:30] But let me just kind of offer. And I don't think it's something you need to hear the kind of some suggestions. So when we met with other applicants, many times we'll have technical assistance, support, coaching, advice, counsel. and I want to just make sure that you get the same benefit of that that we've offered to other applicants. When I read through your application, understanding the prerequisites that you have for students to go into the program, first, I could foresee that there might be students that haven't met those prerequisites that would really want to participate, and it would probably be

[03:50:07] incumbent upon you to have kind of an academic or advising plan on how to ensure that you have open to all students. Relative to that, when I started to do the math on the requirements for a high school diploma here in Virginia, it could get a little tricky for some of the students going through your program if they maybe haven't had one of their history classes or they still have one remaining. And I did see that there was kind of a combination of some courses. What it suggested

[03:50:42] to me was the need to have really intentional academic advising and counseling. And because this is a full-day program and it won't be at Isle of Wight, that having a caring adult maybe on site would really enhance that guidance to these young people. Because I could foresee a situation, like I said, when I did the math where they may need to utilize virtual Virginia.

[03:51:16] they may need to attend a summer course or supplement. And I think those are things that you can address first in your MOU. And you don't have one yet, do you? I didn't see that in the application packet. Is there an MOU between the camp and Isle of Wight yet? Yes. There is a draft MOU. It is included in the packet, Madam Chair. And it's doing its thing between our respective legal counsel but it's been it's been looked at several times and if I could address just briefly

[03:51:54] your comment about the curriculum and what students may need we have thought about that part of setting aside that Wednesday is to provide those opportunities for students who might need something through virtual Virginia or Apex or something like that and there will be three staff members in addition to the faculty or adjuncts that are hired as part of the IMTA, one of those is an advisor position. And we did envision that that person would be someone very accessible to the students and would indeed develop that, discuss and develop career plan and pathway

[03:52:31] with students that would include what they needed for completion of high school. And Isle of White County Schools has also, as part of that MOU, talked with us about providing additional student support for students who may need those opportunities.

[03:52:48] Yes, fantastic. I'm sorry, go ahead. I was just going to add, we already have a fairly robust CTE program and a very extensive counseling career pipeline and planning that goes in place to help identify these students even as early as seventh and eighth grade.

[03:53:07] And we're also on a four by four. So students before they are entering the IMTA, they are already have an opportunity to have earned 16 high school credits just during high school, not including the four that they would have had access to in eighth grade. So given the prerequisites for a standard diploma or even for an advanced studies diploma, I calculated that out for each student.

[03:53:29] I think that there is a real opportunity with very minimal requirements being that they would have to make up during those two years that we wouldn't cover in the dual enrollment courses. exactly cool okay so what i would in the motion what i'm thinking i would like to see um when you go forward to the state board event for their benefit is probably going to be like a finalized mou if or a more robust draft that would cover academic advising extracurriculars meals

[03:54:03] transport special ed ell all the usual buckets um a bit more detail on your utilization of virtual virginia i think in the application it says you're estimating maybe five students a year i would like to see that built out just a bit more i do think there's probably a little bit i think you're going to have a radio relation of that to supplement and maybe they'll do it on the wednesdays but they still need to do it um and then i noticed that there are in the financials there's a chart added on at the very last page that's a little different than some of the other

[03:54:41] financial charts provided in the application and i think it's because as the documents were being added to other items you know documents were added um so i just think that it would behoove you to clean those ones up so i want to give you the heads up that's my intention when we go through the motion um because you you have a great sustainability plan uh there is another document in there that doesn't include all that information and so it kind of presents an incomplete picture so when i was like on page 200 i was concerned when i got to you know the latter part of it i was like okay they have this totally figured out we're good so those would be kind

[03:55:19] of the the suggestions i would have for you what that would look like in a motion i'm just about to do but i wanted to give you the heads up and i also want to check if you have any questions about that madam chair i believe the last document is uh very simply the the reduced down version of the larger fuller budget that was done um in accordance with the template that we were given so i think that that last page is what was also on the last slide of our presentation just to simplify it um so it lacks the detail but the detail is on a different worksheet in

[03:55:56] that but we'll we'll be happy to to remove it if uh no no i like that clarity it is different than one earlier in the application you'll you'll see one when you dig in there's kind of two versions and one looks like an older version and then you have a more recent version and the first one that you read is the older version and not the more updated version and madam chair i want to reassure everyone committee and applicants that we will of course work with our applicants to ensure that these process documents are all cleaned up before we move to the next stage so what i would do at

[03:56:34] this time is i would move to approve quality camp on first and final contingent that the following areas are addressed by the applicant to conform with state law such as number one including a updated either final or draft mou that would include matters such as meals transportation special ed extracurricular and advising number two a more detailed plan on the use of virtual virginia and number three i'll just call it updated financials prior to the deliberation of

[03:57:13] the state board is there is there a motion therein yep i would uh make a motion to uh accept the motion thank you dr man i think i heard you mr hansen as well can i take that to be a second yes yes thank you sir all right all those in favor please signify by saying aye chair votes aye as well any opposed the motion is unanimously approved congratulations

[03:57:50] well done and thank you so much for your high quality application it was really wonderful to read um at this time on behalf of the committee i directed staff to post the policy camp application for a 10-day public comment period in accordance with the standing committee's procedures then compile any comments received for review to be included in the report to be delivered to virginia board of education in their consideration of the quality campus location at their april business meeting all right i'm going to check in with everyone we're about to move to item i i took

[03:58:20] a five-minute break two hours ago shall we take another five-minute break to dr armstrong mr hansen or dr moran i just want to check in before i continue on sure okay we're going to take a

[03:58:38] five-minute break we will be back then at 6 10. thank you all right we are back from recess i can

[04:04:29] see the ODU crowd is my kind of people they're early as on time they logged in before we were back from break thank you for sticking with us i know it's been a long day um but i'm glad we're having the opportunity to consider your application so at this time we're going to proceed with item i which is first and final review of the college partnership laboratory school application from old dominion university newport news the committee will hear from dr sanzo from the Oldham University, Dr. Joanna Garner from Oldham University, and Dr. Rogers, Chief Academic Officer

[04:05:07] of Newport News Public Schools, followed by any other partners that would like to address the Standing Committee. Dr. Sanzo, welcome, and thank you for being with us. Hi, and thank you. I am going to go ahead and share my screen, and Dr. Rogers is going to launch. All right, great. I'll jump right in. Good

evening, esteemed members of the committee. My name is Kip Rogers. As previously mentioned i am the chief proud chief academic officer in newport news newport news public

[04:05:44] schools and i'm of course joined by my colleague dr karen sanzo of old dominion university we also have several members from uh our colleague group from old dominion university i'm sure we'll hear from them shortly i am also joined by my superintendent dr michelle mitchell our school board chairwoman mrs lisa suroslaw she did have a commitment at one of our elementary schools so she had to jump off, and she certainly sends her regards and well wishes as we present this information. I'm also joined by colleagues, Mrs. Tonette Outland, who is our CTE supervisor,

[04:06:19] Dr. Eleanor Blow, who is our director of secondary school leadership. Mrs. Tammy Byron may still be on the call. She's our STEM supervisor. Our secondary science supervisor, Dr. Rodney Cobra House, had to jump off. And then we also have our esteemed grant writer, Mrs. Elizabeth Jackson, who are all joining us this evening. We're happy to be able to present the Maritime Engineering and Environmental Studies Academy, or we call it MISA, which is an innovative collaborative initiative between Oldman University and Newport News Public Schools, for your consideration this

[04:06:54] evening. This lab school embodies an innovative teaching and learning environment that's centered on the maritime industry, engineering, as well as environmental studies. And this evening, we will be providing you with a very high-level overview of how MISA could become a cornerstone for academic excellence, experiential learning, and innovation in support of maritime education. So MISA is a strategic response to a critical workforce need in our community, in Newport News particularly.

[04:07:25] Data from Hanover Research and the Bureau of Labor Statistics point to 53,000 regional jobs in the transportation and shipbuilding sectors, with a workforce study that was conducted in 2019 that highlights several shortages in the era. For example, Newport News Shipbuilding is working to hire 3,000 skilled trades workers this year alone, and a total of 19,000 within a decade.

[04:07:53] And by focusing on maritime engineering, coastal resilience, and digital supply chain, we're directly aligning with regional economic trends and job market demands. So our educational approach for MISA is both innovative and research-supported.

[04:08:11] And in partnership with Old Dominion University, we do plan to utilize student-guided learning, STEM integration, and experiential learning to equip students with the skills that they need for high-demand maritime industry jobs. So in this slide, you'll see the mission is multifaceted to inspire future leaders in Maritime Engineering and Environmental Sciences. And I'll pause for you to take a look at that briefly. And then the vision of MISA is aspirational in nature, and it focuses on being able to stand

[04:08:50] as a beacon of excellence in maritime and environmental education. I'll pause briefly for you to take a look at that. The next slide. One of the questions that we get is what will this look like? So here you'll see a sample student schedule, and you'll notice from the schedule shown how a student's day at MESA would look or be structured like and what it would look like. So students in 11th grade would be transported to the site from their home school after they've eaten breakfast or been provided with breakfast for half the first half of the school day taking courses

[04:09:28] that are aligned with the program's focus. Those students would then be transported back to their home schools to take the remaining full load of courses at their home school. Students in 12th grade would be transported from their homeschools after having eaten breakfast and lunch. Those students in

11th grade will have the opportunity to eat lunch at their schools. The 12th grade students would be transported from their homeschools to the site to take courses and participate in internship and externship courses. And those students would again have lunch at their homeschool

[04:10:01] prior to coming to the site. Part of our process in setting this up would be that Newport News public schools would be responsible for using our existing resources for staffing, for transportation, and certainly for meals and other ancillary materials that students would need to support participation in the program. The slide in front of you does show our instructional focus that's rooted in integrated STEM, where students would engage with real-world problems to develop solutions that are as innovative as they are practical. And through this approach, we feel

[04:10:39] that we would not only foster a deep understanding of maritime engineering and environmental subjects but we also instill in our students the 21st century skills that are necessary for them to excel in those fields so MISA is not just about academics it's about future proofing for our students and they'll have opportunities to earn college credits with Old Dominion University they'll participate in work-based learning experiences and network with potential employers particularly the Shipyard Huntington Ingalls. Our students will also leave MISA with career,

[04:11:15] college career and citizenship ready skills, contributing to a thriving maritime industry. And MISA is certainly more than just an academy program. It's considered to be a commitment to our students' futures, to our community's economic health, as well as to the preservation of our environment. And I want to thank you on behalf of the committee we've been meeting quite frequently, probably every two weeks uh more often than that for you considering this partnership that does promise to yield dividends and not only educational excellence and workforce development for certain years to come and i'll now turn the remainder of the presentation to dr sands

[04:11:54] great thank you and good evening and thank you also for the opportunity to share about our work the proposal has been guided by ongoing conversations as dr rogers reference not only with newport news public schools and odu as well as with partners such as the city of newport news the newport news economic development authority as well as our regional maritime business and industry partners some of whom you see listed here and have also provided letters of support i'm also excited about the potential to partner with t with um camp on their unique maritime proposal which is different from ours yet we complement one another and we will be able to work collectively to address a significant need for maritime professionals in our region

[04:12:34] our school will be positioned at the brooks crossing innovation lab which sits in the nexus of our regional maritime industry including with newport new shipbuilding hii quick access to ports and other maritime and coastal partners we're collaborating with the hampton roads workforce council and odu's maritime team and advisory board to ensure we're aligning with the regional work and college maritime priorities in the upcoming months we'll be working with subject matter experts to focus on curriculum internships and work-based opportunities among other lab school activities so this year coming up will be our startup year where we will continue to dive

[04:13:09] deeper into the planning phases of the work we already are starting our summer recruitment activities so y'all are welcome to come and participate and see the kids in action as we work with students from across the region because this is an open lab school and so we are actively engaging in ways that we can ensure that people are aware of the innovation lab of the lab school and really get involved in their

hands involved in the work before they start applying for it we plan to launch in the fall 2025 with about 55 to 60 juniors attending with a full cohort beginning fall 2026 with juniors and seniors our three-pronged educator development approach

[04:13:48] includes building the next generation of future stem and cte teachers as we know cte a significant need for virginia through working with the teachers for tomorrow program in newport news and providing high school potential educators experience in our lab school and then ideally attending odu and continuing their ed prep journey preparing teacher candidates also through rigorous field-based residencies and apprenticeships and leveraging the innovation lab as a professional development hub for innovative lesson development and design for practicing teachers our research model uses a design-based implementation research approach that integrates faculty public school educators business and industry experts and others for designing and testing our educational

[04:14:26] innovations. And this is really an important part of our sustainability plan because we want to be able to ensure that we are testing out these innovations, identifying the ones that are effective and being as cost effective and efficient as we possibly can as we transition from the grant funding into our sustainability years. We want to ensure that we're using evidence to make decisions that positively support student learning and evidence that contributes to our continuous improvement model. Our funding model here presents our four-year grant funded request paired with the start of our sustainable non-state funded year five. Our institution, along

[04:15:02] with Newport News Public Schools, has already made a significant investment. And I have to say that the conversation previously with the local share, I recognize that on this one and the other chart, some of that is missing. Newport News has, and I will go back and make those adjustments. And I know for both of these, those will work on those in the upcoming days.

[04:15:23] Newport News has made significant personnel investments already. They are providing the funding for the teachers that will be in here. We will provide additional funding through ODU and with the grant. So I want to be clear that the local share that Newport News has definitely committed resources, money and time into this. We feel that our proposal is well positioned to easily transition to a fully sustainable model, given our financial projections, the focused work, the investment that both of our institutions have already committed. Some of this is going into base funding at the university starting next year. I think it's around $40,000 in year one, and then

[04:16:03] it's progressively increasing as we move forward into the base funding. And so the College of Education, for example, has also created a Director of Strategic Partnerships position, of which some of that time is going to be committed to helping support the lab school efforts through the educator prep.

[04:16:19] And so we've already made those significant investments. Our sustainability plan really rests on our strong history of sustainability of initiatives. Our sustainability plan has already started. So we're beginning with that transition in mind. We have the commitments that we know are coming in, both from Newport News and ODU, putting into base funding for next year with the university, looking at that teacher-based funding coming from our partnership.

[04:16:43] The project has the support of multiple offices within ODU, which has committed resources. Project staff are proactively developing relationships in the communities local to the lab school, which will help build support for the school and potentially open avenues to new community funding streams. We'll

leverage our research to demonstrate the innovations, as I referenced before, as we want as we continue to move into the self-funded years.

[04:17:06] We intend, of course, to continue to pursue grants, have identified ones that we feel would be well positioned here. educator preparation program has over a decade of ongoing grant funding to support educator development that we will continue to leverage the innovation lab so at the innovation lab we've already received funding from the regional hampton roads workforce council they have helped as well as with go virginia funding we have equipment between we've had about half a million dollars of investments already coming into that and we have staff that's a part of the ilr work with go tech that are also there we are also working to identify key stakeholders they'll

[04:17:45] be able to contribute financially as well as through human capital and other avenues such as field-based experiences internships and mentors we're partnering with the odu supply chain logistics and maritime operations council we're also developing an innovative fundraising approach to support the school efforts again i mentioned the support of the positions through base funding and the institutional commitments that are already set forth i do want to express my thanks to newport news and to our industry and stakeholder partners have been at the table and it's really been a powerful opportunity experience and again thank you for the opportunity to share

[04:18:18] and present thank you very much excuse me um i'm just going to note excuse me for the record we received a note from the hampton roads chamber i'm just going to read it to put it up on the record um or dr um is this something where you can make sure that that gets included in the minutes from the meeting i just want to make sure that that's actually for chesapeake oh i'm so sorry thank you that's okay two odio applications my apologies yeah okay that's okay yeah all right but i

[04:18:52] appreciate that though i always want to make sure that when folks take the time to uh come to a meeting again to be a partner that we certainly know for the record so either dr santo are there other individuals that are here that would like to speak to your application yes we we do um and and we do have some that had to leave our vice provost had to leave for example and others but we do have some that are here and excited for our partners so dr rogers if you want to introduce

[04:19:22] um your team sure i i um mentioned them during the first slide and uh i know i see our superintendent Dr. Michelle Mitchell is on the call. Our CTE supervisor, Tonette Allen, is on the call.

[04:19:39] Our director of school leadership, secondary school leadership is on the call. Tammy Byron is our supervisor of STEM. Oh, our school board chair joined us. Mrs. Searles Law is on the call. And then our grant writer, Elizabeth Jackson, is on the call. And if I'm missing anybody else it's just because i don't see you guys and uh i think that's it did i miss anybody did you you said tonette yes yes okay i did i did hi yes so if um if your team members

[04:20:16] want to speak to support and then we also have representatives from newport news ship and the city of newport news i think are here yes we have um owen miller is here from newport news and few folks. So, Dr. Mrs. Charles-Law, would you like to speak? Dr. Mitchell?

[04:20:35] Yes, absolutely. What an honor to have the chance for us to be considered for this opportunity. I think for me and my perspective with our board, that this initiative is something that will enhance the offerings that we have for our students. I cannot emphasize it enough that those who are involved are

those who are really um passionate and committed a committed group of professionals um that are going to focus on the the needs of our students um i think one of the

[04:21:13] things that i'm most uh excited about is the is having appreciation for the keen attention to recruitment and the assessment efforts for this um this program so the school board is delighted for the possibility to have this opportunity and we thank you. And Dr. Rogers, I will jump in right after Ms. Searle's Law. I'm in complete agreement with everything, of course, that she said, but I think this is an opportunity for a transformative initiative that really is going to help refine maritime education as well as workforce development in our region, which as you know is

[04:21:51] vital. It is vital to us at this time. So it really also reflects on our broader mission to empower our students with knowledge and skills and opportunities that they're going to need in order to thrive in the 21st century to be able to move us forward. So we are excited. The commitment from the school board and from the superintendent's office is here and we just stand ready to support to move this initiative forward. Thank you for the opportunity. Thank you. Anyone else from the Yes, we have Rob Geis from Newport News and then Owen Miller.

[04:22:30] Great. Can you hear me okay? Yes, sir. Okay, great. Good evening. My name is Dr. Rob Geis. I'm an Associate Technical Fellow here at Newport News Shipbuilding. And thank you for the opportunity to speak today and for considering this super critical proposal.

[04:22:49] Newport News Shipbuilding completely supports the Mesa Lab School, and we view this effort as an enabler for our workforce development. As each of you know, the work in new permanent shipbuilding is critically important to the United States in the defense of our nation.

[04:23:05] The Lab School will help motivate and encourage students to learn about the maritime industry and consider a career in this very important area. We want to see this become a successful endeavor for our future leaders within the maritime industry and future leaders of society.

[04:23:23] And we have already put this in writing as well in support of the proposal. Thank you very much for being able to share some comments. And again, Newfoundland Shipbuilding strongly supports this endeavor. So thank you. Thank you very much.

[04:23:41] Good evening. So my name is Owen Miller. I currently serve as an Acting Assistant City Manager. Just first of all, I wanted to send my appreciation to be able to address the committee tonight. I just wanted to quickly share similar sentiments on behalf of the City Manager, Mayor Jones, and the entire City Council.

[04:24:00] We are very excited about this opportunity and wanted to lend our support to it. This collaboration with Newport News Public Schools and ODU already exists in our partnership with the Brooks Crossing Innovation and Opportunity Center, but this also supports the city's strategic plan, specifically related to our education, learning, and opportunity for economic prosperity.

[04:24:26] I think finally, I'd simply say and kind of echo some of the comments that have been made by others. I mean, this lab school really supports not only our students, our educators, employers, and residents, and really addresses some of those future workforce needs. So the city stands behind this and will certainly support it in any way we can. I'll be happy to stand for any questions.

[04:24:47] Otherwise, I'll turn it over to Karen. Thank you. Great. Thank you. I think that's, if I'm missing somebody, let me know. I know we had some that had to log off. Well, it's an impressive team. Let me go to our committee members.

[04:25:05] I know there's been some enthusiasm about their application. So I expect this might go swiftly. Mr. Hanson, to you first. - Yeah, just thanks Madam Chair. And just indeed a lot of enthusiasm and just thank you as well as for the universal support that you've got from the community and from all of your academic leadership.

[04:25:29] And I really do, I think the instructional focus the stem and career ready and the maritime industry connections are all just um really i love the connective tissue with all of it and maybe on a lighter note i think with having kids have a 7 25 class on renewable energy i think we could all benefit from that at 7 25 in the morning having renewable energy but um i just at all um seriously so i dr rogers and dr sanzo i just uh

[04:26:05] really just appreciate your leadership and um uh just bringing um you know for this late in the day at 6 30 an hour and a half past schedule just uh uh really appreciate the commitment and uh to you know getting us over the goal line so thank you dr moran i would just say that that one of the areas in the proposal that i was particularly appreciative of and thank you for being with us

[04:26:40] today um superintendent mitchell and um our board uh representative it's great to see you here because we don't always get a board representative at our meeting so thank you for being here and dr rogers you and your team as well um one of the things that i really particularly liked was a focus on your core design principles that one of the areas that you're trying to do is to really build teacher capacity to use the design principles or the kind of instruction that that students will be getting in these core courses that you've identified and i'm just wondering if if there

[04:27:17] are any particular areas of teacher development that you see as being critical for teachers to be able to effectively teach in the the lab school environment in these particular courses or whether you feel like that that's going to be something that emerges as you move forward i'll take a stab at that good to see you um dr moran good to see you so yes i think one of the the big premises is to focus on experiential learning as well as making uh learning real

[04:27:52] in context so that will be probably a large focus on on on uh working with our teachers is to help them understand uh how to help kids understand why they are learning these things and the and applicability that they have in the real world.

[04:28:18] - Dr. Moran? - Yeah, I may wanna come back. I'm gonna let you go ahead and then circle back. I may have one other area that I wanted to focus on. - No, no, Dr. Moran, please consider.

[04:28:35] - When you talk about your targeted student population, I really appreciate your focus on making sure that the lab school to the greatest degree possible is going to represent the range of demographics that are present in Newport News.

[04:28:58] And anyone that knows Newport News knows that you have a very diverse population. How do you intend to go after recruiting students into the program? And do you see any particular barriers that might potentially keep some students from seeing themselves as being a part of the lab school?

[04:29:26] - I can speak a little bit to some of the work that we've already started. And so we've been partnering with Newport News, with the STEM program, with the family and community engagement. We've been partnering with the city of Newport News as well to engage in outreach.

[04:29:44] So it's multiple channels. So it's a full on blast to everybody in the school system to let them know about the innovation lab. part of it is just that level of awareness how are we going to convince 11th and 12th graders to leave their home school and to come somewhere else and so we we have had after school activities we have had field trips out to the innovation lab throughout the entire year we're partnering with newport news right now where we are having summer camps specifically targeting the students that we are going to be recruiting to come that grade level both for next year recruiting as well

[04:30:21] well as starting with sixth grade and really pushing back in and bringing them out there. And so it's a lot of exposure. We've also had family makerspace nights so that they can come out. We've had community makerspaces. One of the really cool things that the city of Newport News does, and they have a STEM day in October. And I think, Owen, we had about a thousand people that came out to the Innovation Lab in October. And so we're able to leverage that. So it's not just from Newport News. It's people from around the area. So again, to give them that level of experience. Also, it's working with parents to inform them as what is the maritime industry,

[04:30:58] what supply chain, what is engineering in maritime, what cyber security. And so it's that experience, it's that comfort and being able to, as Dr. Rogers referenced, it's the experiential learning opportunities. And so we want students grades six through 10, as they start to think about the possibility of the lab school to have those experiential learning opportunities and really see it as a place where it's a very different learning environment, where they're getting their hands dirty in the maker space, you know, they're out there, they're at the Virginia, at the Living Museum, and, or the, excuse, not the Living Museum, but the Maritime

[04:31:36] Museum. It's late, and I still have to teach tonight. And I'll also let Dr. Roger speak a little bit, too, with that. So part of the, what, you did a great job. The other piece is making students aware that there are careers that are associated with maritime and in general just the supply chain is relatively a new term for us in education who are not very close to that work and making it attractive to students to even want to come in the in the area of maritime

[04:32:14] so part of that process is making sure that we partner with all of our different departments that we have and making sure that we sell it to students such that they have a clear understanding about what it is that they're getting into as well as their families because many of our families are not really aware about what uh maritime the maritime industry is absent you know what they see with in the shipyard that would be a barrier because of the not necessarily a barrier but just the lack of awareness about the careers that are associated uh with maritime yeah and and just

[04:32:48] figuring out all the different pathways to have families become engaged is something i know you're going to work on um thank you and and also hats off to the through the residency program that you're embedding in this i think that's another piece that that i see is somewhat unique that we haven't seen necessarily in all of the proposals that have come in front of us we like that thank you yeah thanks and we have a great partnership with the college of education um dr barber here is the one who's leading that part of it until the strategic partnership director comes on board

[04:33:22] but we're very happy to be able to have that as a part of it well since you've heard the deliberation i hope you'll appreciate the the compliments of you have a very clean application thank you enthusiastic about it i you have proactively addressed any remaining questions that i may have had in your presentation and i want to say how meaningful it is to not only have employers odu representatives newport news school board representatives newport news staff

[04:33:59] representatives faculty and a city a partner on this and the letters of support you have the commitments that you've made it's precisely the type of application they're looking for the only item might be to update those financials before it goes before the board because i think you have a more persuasive and comprehensive story to tell on sustainability um and we've already talked about that but at this time it is my pleasure um to know is there a motion to approve the odu report news on first and final contending that the applicant updates the financial plan

[04:34:38] i salute second all those in favor please signify by saying aye aye aye care votes aye as well and the motion unanimously passes and congratulations at this time i would direct on behalf of the committee the staff to post the odu newport news application for a 10-day public comment period in accordance with the standing committee's procedures and compile any comments received to be reviewed and included in the report to be delivered to the virginia board of education in their consideration of the odu newport news application at their upcoming business meeting

[04:35:13] and at this time we'll return to the last agenda item on our meeting which is item j first review of the college partnership laboratory school application from odu chesapeake thanks madam chair um if i may very quickly as a son grandson great grandson of a shipyard worker and proud product with newport news public schools i'm especially excited about that application so thank you thank you dr armstrong for sharing that with us after the fact too like that that took a lot of restraint gotta keep it all in the lines here right that's the first time we've heard that

[04:35:52] that's the first time we've heard that that just shows the good diligence that dr armstrong did and his staff work okay so item j um all right so we have uh this evening to hear from let's see oh dr sanzo you're back up and uh dr windham director of college and career readiness at chesitate public schools will present to the standing committee thank you

[04:36:30] welcome back great yes thank you you you may hear a couple familiar things and in part what we're doing is we're embracing a community-based lab school partnership that we were really inspired by our visit to san antonio when everybody except me because i got covet the day before the trip 18 between newport news and chesapeake went out to visit the utsa lab schools we were connected with them through our visit earlier in the year to the international association of laboratory schools conference and so um i would say that so you'll see this partnership and collaboration

[04:37:07] across the projects while they're unique there are some similarities there and so we have that through line across so dr windham is going to begin and then also dr garner with the center for educational partnerships will speak and then i'll conclude i'll go ahead and share my screen thank you good afternoon madam chair and committee members it is indeed our pleasure to share information with you this evening about our proposed computer science lab school

[04:37:40] i will say i will start by saying unfortunately our superintendent and our school board chair who were both planning to be here this evening were unable to due to a pre-schedule board meeting, but we do have our chief academic officer present, Diane Edwards, who will share some comments later in the

presentation. So our computer science lab school is dedicated to seamlessly integrating computer science into the curriculum through a human-centered design thinking framework.

[04:38:19] in alignment with research emphasizing the importance of early academic preparation for underrepresented students in the technology talent pipeline the lab school will actively recruit fifth sixth and seventh grade students we believe that our lab school will support the need for computer science and engineering professionals which has escalated in the past decade with over 600 computing jobs available in the united states and less than 72 000 new computer science graduates

[04:38:56] each year the need for more computing graduates is clear um dr sanzo if you don't mind going back one slide i think this is where i'm actually referencing here the future growth of the technology sector requires a workforce trained in computer science and engineering so waiting until students are in high school or college to start preparing them for computer science pathways is insufficient. The mission of the Lab School is to foster a comprehensive understanding of

[04:39:32] computer science principles and practices among students to prepare them for careers in technology and equip them with the skills necessary to navigate a rapidly evolving digital landscape. our vision of the lab school is to provide a space to prepare middle school students academically to excel in high school while increasing their confidence with the use of technology as mentioned earlier the computer science lab school will use a human-centered design thinking framework with an infusion of computer science curriculum the lab school will

[04:40:09] offer design thinking practices to students and teachers to shape innovative teaching and learning activities students will learn to apply practical and creative thinking skills to solve design problems which are crucial skills for success in computer science coursework elective courses will be enhanced with specialized technology integration hands-on projects field trips and innovative classroom designs for example students will be introduced to i.t coding healthcare engineering

[04:40:43] welding, and precision machining in a new career investigations course. The lab school will encourage greater collaboration between education providers from middle school through the post-secondary level. Through professional development opportunities with Code VA and ODU, teachers will collaborate to build best practices, create a culture that values computer science, and provide rich academic learning. Finally, we hope to expand community partnerships to assist

[04:41:17] with student mentorship, career exploration, as well as program sustainability. Before you now is the proposed schedule of a computer science lab school student. In each course, students will be empowered with the knowledge, skills, and mindset needed to succeed in a digital world, to drive innovation, and to make meaningful contributions to society through technology. Through design thinking practices, students will learn to critically think to solve complex challenges

[04:41:50] and enhance their visual and verbal communication skills. Students will be exposed to college and career-focused experiences via job shadowing, field trips, college visits, mentorships, etc. Our goal is to ensure that CSLS students leave us prepared for the next level of college and career readiness.

[04:42:14] At this time, Dr. Garner will share more about the Lab School's instructional approach. Thank you, Dr. Windham, and good evening, everyone. I'm the Executive Director of the Center for Educational Partnerships. We are a university-wide enterprise center at ODU that has been in operation for approximately 15 years.

[04:42:34] We have gathered more than $40 million in STEM-related education grants for Virginia, and in particular for our local area. And we have a sustained partnership with Code VA, VDOE, and with our local school systems, including Chesapeake Public Schools, to provide high-quality, innovative professional development.

[04:42:58] The lab school's innovations include coursework that integrates computer science into STEM and humanities content areas. It will provide sustained professional development for current and pre-service teachers. CS career knowledge and readiness will be enhanced through mentoring programs that connect the lab school teachers and students with college students and faculty and regional industry leaders.

[04:43:22] and a school leadership community of practice will be established that will also include embedded PD. So to continue our instructional approach and innovations, integrated coursework will provide a foundation for enhanced computer science and STEM career-oriented electives.

[04:43:44] Each year, students will showcase their applications of computer science through capstone projects and an electronic portfolio. These will also be built into their assessment. these components will be taught in collaborative learning spaces. And now I will turn it over to Dr. Sanzo. Great, yes, thank you again, and thank you for hearing our proposal and your time and consideration of our work. So I do want to thank our partner, Chesapeake Public Schools, for their ongoing work, dedication, and collaboration. I think we have spent a year and a half going through

[04:44:19] this, site visits, different states, on-site, other locations. And so we're not only fortunate to collaborate with our chesapeake public schools partner in the lab design but also identify and connect with those interested dedicated to the lab school we're engaged with for example the chesapeake economic development authority again airtime area maritime computer science and cyber security partners as evidence in our letters of support and we're working also with the hampton roads workforce council to collaborate around the ways which we can develop a sustainable computer science school and contribute to the ongoing long-term development of our regional workforce and support a healthy regional economy as i mentioned before as a part of our partnership

[04:44:58] it extends to the national laboratory school network we've been able to visit the network of lab schools led by a single university visit a lab school in the state and they attended the conference last year sorry that's the slide i meant to have it on there so our startup again next year startup 2024 will be actively recruiting students both within chesapeake as well as around the region as again this lab school isn't open open to any student within the commonwealth of virginia in 2025-26 we're going to start with 200 students so next year will be active

[04:45:33] professional development really uh unboxing the makerspace items unpacking it training around design thinking training around computer science really integrating that curriculum development working with businesses and industry partners to identify those problems of practice as we put those into the lessons and build out those units for our students and then with 300 students so we'll have one team six seven eight hundred hundred hundred um so again our model includes a three-pronged approach for educator development so as dr garner mentioned we have the center for educational partnerships and cps collaborating on customized professional

[04:46:12] development to support integration of computer science instruction with coursework collaborating with monarch teach to bring stem cs teacher candidates to the school and focus on

computer science integrated projects and preparing teacher candidates through rigorous field-based residencies and apprentice models as you'll notice our research model aligns with our newport news public schools proposal we are very focused on having this alignment while we may be studying different interventions we want to upskill teachers administrators and really cultivate this network and this community of practice we're mindful of teacher retention we feel that having that community of practice will help with that retention as well as to provide those skills to

[04:46:52] teachers and also we want our students to be actively researching the schools as well and so providing teachers training on researches and then having our students engaged in that our research model uses a design-based implementation research approach and integrates faculty public school educators and others into testing our educational innovations using evidence to make decisions and that contributes to our positive to our continuous improvement model this is probably not the slide that i meant to put in there sorry this and it's the same piece that i mentioned before in the application it does we did we did not put in the

[04:47:28] local support chesapeake has deeply invested in that local commitment to the school so they are providing that base funding for the salaries for the teachers in the school and so they are dedicating the time the space the resources the university is more than willing to write that letter of commitment and we will do that and have that in the application in addition to and we'll do that for the other one as well and we'll have that in addition to updating the commitment in our five-year projection so we recognize that again as referenced before the university has created the position for the strategic partnerships where a percentage of that time is working with the lab

[04:48:04] school teachers the university is putting in the base funding to help support the work that we are focusing on and we're committed to making this successful so as referenced before we have a strong history of sustainability of initiatives i probably don't need to go through it because it's it parallels a couple things i do want to mention is that we already have grant funding coming in that is separate from this with the ialr with the go tech program so that is grant funded we are working with the hampton roads workforce council to look at the maritime funding that's

[04:48:39] coming in and to see where we align with the various tiers as we move forward and we are also working with our partners not only for financial contributions as well as looking at again we need mentors we need internships and to be able to work through those but so again thank you we appreciate the opportunity to present and to share and look forward to your feedback and i just again want to express my thanks to the partners in chesapeake it's it's been a really great powerful learning experience so thank you thank you dr sanzo are there other members from the chesapeake

[04:49:15] team that would like to address the standing committee at this time yes i would be happy to my name is diana edwards i am the chief academic officer and was stated earlier our superintendent dr jared cotton and our school board chair mrs andrew swigert had to leave at five o'clock for our school board meeting i suspect they would much rather be here but i am in their place because i I wanted to articulate their support of this project.

[04:49:41] As has been mentioned, we are very excited and looking forward to hopefully moving forward. The Computer Lab School at Oscar Smith Middle will be at our only Title I middle school in the city. And in this school, 84% roughly of the enrollment is minority, 97% receive free and reduced lunch.

[04:50:02] But we want this to be very unapologetically the middle school of choice for all students due to the innovative offerings that can foster student curiosity, awareness, engagement. Our partnership with the university has been very positive so far.

[04:50:20] We will also benefit our adults as we build teacher instructional capacity with quality professional development. but probably most important to our focus and our why is the children and their families deserve to see a school where they can experience perhaps what they can't dream of now.

[04:50:41] Many of our students live in a neighborhood where their families previously attended a school, they may not have access or even the comfort level to attend other programs, even within our city. So even though this program, we're excited about inviting people and children from all across the city and across the state.

[04:51:01] We're super excited about the possibility of creating a very highly coveted learning place right in our backyard. So thank you for listening to our presentation. We're very excited and very hopeful that we will be able to move forward.

[04:51:18] - Thank you, Dr. Edwards. Mr. Solis. - Hi, yes ma'am, Madam Chair and committee members. I just really wanna thank you for all your time and dedication now this evening that's gone into the good work of all the applications that we've used together today.

[04:51:35] So my name is Brian Solis. I'm a deputy city manager here with the city of Chesapeake and just want to convey that the city and Chesapeake Public Schools are in lockstep with this last school's opportunity. You know, we're digging deeper together down to the middle school level and cultivating our next generation workforce, you know, with hopes that they'll stay in Hampton Roads here, or at the very least here, stay in the Commonwealth to build a career and be contributing members to our community as young adults.

[04:52:04] So thank you for having us. Great. Thank you. And then we have a colleague from our computer science, Dr. Jarathna. Good evening, everyone. I'm Dr. Sampar Jarathna. I'm an assistant professor of computer science and also on the graduate program for the newly established School of Data Science.

[04:52:25] So we appreciate your time. And I'm excited about this opportunity and we are fully committed as a computer science department as a school of data science. We are fully committed for this opportunity. You probably hear that the School of Data Science recently approved to start a Bachelor of Data Science program.

[04:52:46] And also we are looking forward to start a PhD program as well in the future. So this is a great opportunity for us to commit our resources and opportunities to work together in this partnership. And we appreciate all the opportunity and we are fully committed for this proposal.

[04:53:05] - Thank you. - So I'm not sure if there's anybody else. I don't know, Dr. Barber, I don't wanna put you on the spot, but if there's anybody else from the team that wants to share. - This is Maggie Barber at ODU. I would like to mention one point briefly.

[04:53:21] I'm the Associate Dean for Academic of Programs and Assessment in our Darden College of Education and Professional Studies. And this proposal reflects deep work in thinking not only about the

lives and opportunities for the students in Chesapeake, but also for the opportunities for the teachers as well.

[04:53:38] And thinking about how we address incredibly thorny problem of the teacher pipeline through innovative approaches like teacher residencies as well as converting pair professionals who are already committed to our schools for very low wages into fully licensed individuals with bachelor's degrees ready to meet the needs of their students so we're very excited to bring our expertise together with that of the of chesapeake to be able to support not only the students but also the adults learning alongside them thank you at this time i'll go to committee members and see if they have any comments or

[04:54:15] questions mr hansen we'll go to you first sir thank you and thank you dr windham dr sanzo this again i appreciate very much the fact that this is a title one um middle school and uh just uh i really feel the depth that you put into this i think the your travels and your research and you're reaching out to other uh lab schools nationally i just uh it's really i think evident

[04:54:49] in your proposal of what you've put together here so just um and i could ask some technical questions but this late the time in the evening i will spare them but just uh and thank you for your thoughtfulness and just i'm really uh really grateful for the community that you're supporting and serving so thank you dr moran i just i feel like that that just as in the other proposal with

[04:55:24] newport news you've put together a really nice package of work that represents innovation represents a different approaches that's what the whole lab school model is about you're building out teacher um efficacy and um skill sets and expertise on both sides of the equation so i really appreciate that i am really interested about um and it's great to have you with us doctor i want to make sure i get this right giraffna was i close close on that um that you're bringing a data science perspective into this because with the department of education

[04:56:02] rolling out a data science set of standards to be integrated across content not just specific to math or science but how does data science really play out in social studies in um in even language arts um and and really excited about the potential to see that become a signature piece of perhaps this lab school project because i do think that that represents um the the coming of age of um mathematical analytical computational thinking in careers that most people traditionally would

[04:56:40] never see as needing to have data science skillfulness so thank you and i i don't know if there's anything that you would comment on that but just appreciate that you're here and that that is um embedded um within this project uh thank you dr marat uh so one thing i want to mention is that um you know we go and talk to a lot of the school around here in hampton road uh one of the things that we notice is that a lot of the kids uh they don't know what is data science so so it's interesting that you know we see how the industry is kind of changing um so there is this notion

[04:57:13] that uh this computer science is a highly paid uh area but um there is double the amount of money that you can make as a data scientist so this is uh you know i mean you know i mean uh something that that we can educate um and i think this this may be a great piece that we can uh you know put into our work with the lab school. So I think we have immense opportunity with the age of AI, machine learning and all these things that is happening out there. There's a lot of excitement about it and we appreciate your support for this. Dr. Moran, if I can just jump in. We at TSAP,

[04:57:51] at the Center for Educational Partnerships, we've had actually three substantial computer science integration grants, one federal grant and two local grants, region two focused grants. And so we actually are already working with some of the Chesapeake educators. And as you know, it's required that computer science is integrated into the curriculum. It's integrated into the core content areas. And so we have staff, we have faculty on staff at TSEP who have exactly this background. They're already working with educators across the Commonwealth synchronously and

[04:58:28] asynchronously. We have micro-credentials specifically for K-8 and specifically for middle school for 6-8 CS integration. And we are producing resources that can then be used in local settings too. One of the things that I think is particularly exciting about this opportunity is we've run several years of in-person professional development and workshops.

[04:58:53] And to be able to see teachers who are teaching, let's say, social studies or English or writing, and they get their hands on the CS, the tools and the resources, the things they come up with are just incredible.

[04:59:10] And so we're really excited because we know that's what's going to happen at Oscar Smith Middle. Awesome. I mean, it's just wonderful when you start to see teachers picking up tools like CodeApp and being able to apply it almost immediately in their work. So hats off to you for doing that. And I think about this kind of program as really being something that represents.

[04:59:29] I had a principal at a school that I work with outside of Virginia say to me, you know, Pam, I would really love to see us start to move away from the concept of focusing on seat time and heading our kids towards seeing themselves as revenue generators, because this is the kind of work that really builds out young people who can start to believe that, hey, I can generate revenue pretty quickly with the skill sets that I'm learning in school. And that's not just about high school. I think we have middle schoolers who are fully capable of taking this work on.

[05:00:03] So thank you very much for believing in middle schoolers, particularly middle schoolers who some folks would say can't do this work and seeing them as fully capable of uh jumping in on it so thank you very much thank you dr moran i want to again compliment this application and your collective partnership between the city the university the school board or the superintendent's office the

[05:00:34] quality of this application is evidence and the fact that you're literally ticking all the boxes of what makes for a high-quality lab school, as we heard from the International Association of Lab Schools.

[05:00:53] Quality instruction, quality in terms of teaching, quality in terms of considering research and practice. And so your diligence and outreach to ILF shows in the application. And I want to compliment you, and thank you for helping set that mark in our deliberation.

[05:01:14] At this time, it would be my pleasure to see if there is a motion to approve ODU Chesapeake on first and final contingent that the applicant provide a letter of commitment and updates financial plan. I'll move it. Is there a second?

[05:01:30] Second. All those in favor of the motion, please signify by saying aye. Aye. Chair votes aye as well. The motion is unanimously approved. Congratulations. At this time, on behalf of the committee, I direct the staff to post the ODU Chesapeake for attending public comment period in accordance with the standing committee's procedures and compile any comments received for the review to be included in their report to deliver to the Virginia Board of Education in their consideration of the ODE Chesapeake

application at their upcoming April business meeting. Thank you very much. Thank you. At this time, is there discussion

[05:02:05] of any current issues from committee members? No. I did think so. Is there any public comment on not agenda item no okay um our next standing meeting is scheduled for may 6th hearing no further business we are adjourned thank you for your time and attention today congratulations thank you all thank you thank you so much thank you thank you thanks for hanging in with us thanks staff andy and crew thank you thank you all

